

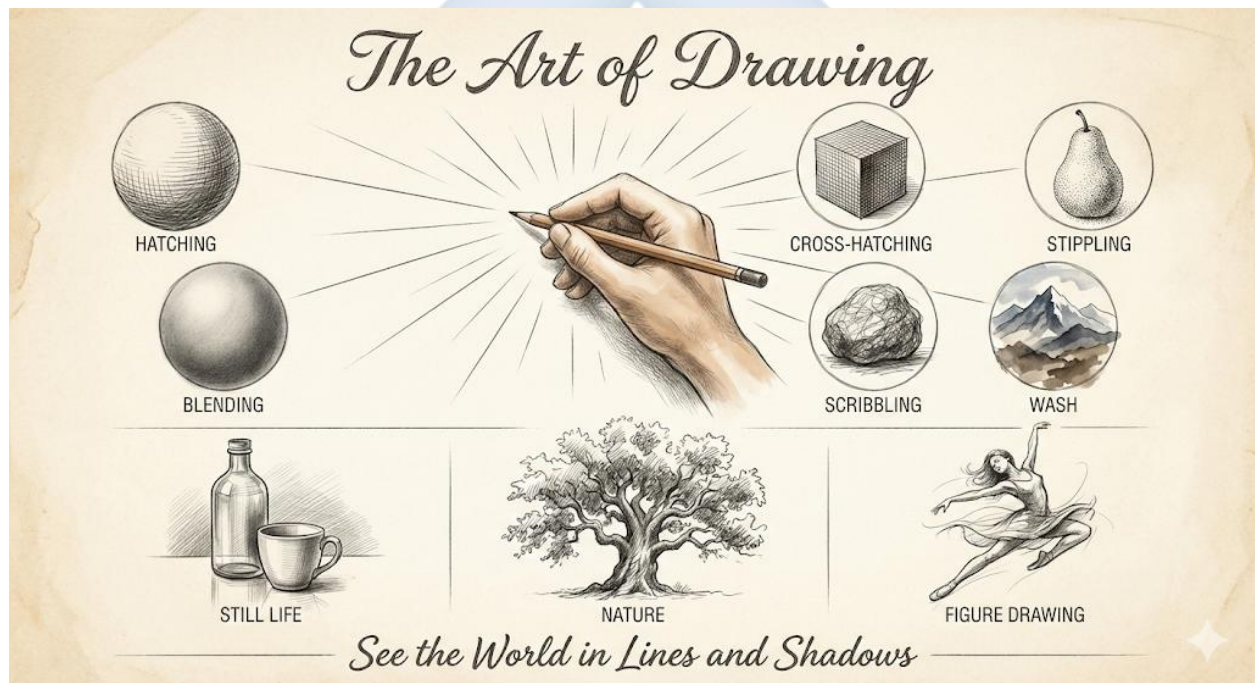
SS2 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: DRAWING

1.1 INTRODUCTION TO DRAWING

Drawing is the foundation of all visual arts. It is the art of representing objects, ideas, or forms on a surface (like paper, canvas, or a wall) using lines, shapes, and shading. The most fundamental skill in drawing is not holding the pencil, but **keen observation**: learning to see the world not just as "a tree" or "a face," but as a collection of shapes, lines, tones, and textures.



1.2 CATEGORIES AND TYPES OF DRAWING

Drawings can be categorized by their subject matter:

- **STILL LIFE DRAWING:** The drawing of inanimate (non-moving) objects. These are often household items arranged by the artist (e.g., a bowl of fruit, a kettle, books, a chair).

- **NATURE DRAWING:** The drawing of objects from the natural world (e.g., a flower, a landscape, a tree, an animal, insects, bones).
- **FIGURE DRAWING:** The drawing of the human form. This includes:
 - **Portraiture:** A drawing focusing on the face and head.
 - **Full Life Drawing:** A drawing of the entire human body.

Drawings can also be classified by their purpose and surface effect:

- **CONTOUR DRAWING:** A drawing that uses only lines to define the *outer edge* and *internal details* of an object. There is no shading.
- **GESTURE DRAWING:** A quick, expressive drawing that captures the *movement*, *action*, or *pose* of a subject (especially in figure drawing).
- **SKETCHING:** A rapid, exploratory drawing used to jot down ideas or capture a subject quickly.
- **PERSPECTIVE DRAWING:** A technical drawing that creates the illusion of three-dimensional space (depth and distance) on a flat surface.

1.3 SHADING TECHNIQUES

Shading is the process of adding value (lightness and darkness) to a drawing to make objects look solid (3D) and to show how light hits them.

1. **HATCHING:** Using a series of parallel lines to create shadow. The closer the lines are, the darker the shadow appears.
2. **CROSS-HATCHING:** Building on hatching, this involves drawing a second set of lines that *cross* the first set, usually at an angle. This technique builds up very dark, rich tones.
3. **STIPPLING (POINTILLISM):** Creating tone and shadow by using thousands of tiny dots. The denser the dots, the darker the area. This is a very time-consuming but effective technique.
4. **BLENDING / SMUDGING ("BURNING"):** (The term "burning" is likely a typo for "blending" or "burnishing"). This involves smoothing the pencil marks with a finger, a piece of paper, or a special tool called a "stump" to create soft, gradual tones.

5. **LINE (SCRIBBLING):** Using loose, expressive, and uncontrolled "scribbled" lines to build up shadow and texture. This is often used in gesture drawing.
6. **WASH:** A technique used with ink or watercolour. The artist dilutes the ink with water to create different shades of grey (or a lighter colour) and "washes" it onto the paper with a brush.

EVALUATION

1. What is the most fundamental skill in drawing?
2. Differentiate between Still Life drawing and Nature drawing.
3. What is the main purpose of a "gesture drawing"?
4. Explain the difference between Hatching and Cross-Hatching.
5. What is "stippling"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Set up a simple still life at home (e.g., a bottle, a cup, and a spoon).
2. On a single sheet of paper, draw this still life.
3. Divide the drawing's background into four sections and shade each section using a *different* technique: Cross-Hatching, Stippling, Blending, and Scribbling.

WEEK 2: PAINTING

2.1 INTRODUCTION TO PAINTING

Painting is the practice of applying paint, pigment, or other media to a surface (like canvas, paper, or a wall). While drawing often relies on lines, painting relies on the application of **colour**, **tone**, and **texture**.



2.2 STYLES AND TECHNIQUES OF PAINTING

1. **MURAL PAINTING:** The art of painting directly onto a wall or ceiling. It is one of the oldest art forms, seen in caves and ancient cities.
2. **FRESCO:** A specific type of mural painting where the pigment is mixed with water and applied to wet plaster. As the plaster dries, the painting becomes a permanent part of the wall.
3. **TEMPERA:** A traditional paint medium where the pigment is mixed with a water-soluble binder, usually **egg yolk**. It dries very quickly and has a flat, matte finish.

4. **IMPASTO:** A technique where paint (usually oil or acrylic) is applied very thickly, almost like paste. The artist's brush or palette knife strokes are clearly visible, giving the painting texture and a 3D effect.
5. **ANIMAL HIDE PAINTING:** A traditional form (common in many cultures) where scenes are painted onto the treated and dried skin of an animal.

2.3 SUBJECT MATTER IN PAINTING

Like drawing, painting covers various subjects:

- **STILL LIFE OBJECTS:** (e.g., chair, plates, kettle). This is a common exercise for learning colour and form.
- **NATURAL OBJECTS:** (e.g., insects, animals, bones, flowers).
- **FIGURE DRAWING/PAINTING:**
 - **PORTRAIT:** A painting of a person's face.
 - **FULL LIFE PAINTING:** A painting of the entire human figure.

2.4 COLOUR MIXING AND APPLICATION

Colour is the heart of painting. Understanding the **Colour Wheel** is essential.

- **PRIMARY COLOURS:** The three colours that cannot be mixed from other colours: **Red, Yellow, Blue (RYB).**
- **SECONDARY COLOURS:** Made by mixing two primary colours:
 - Red + Yellow = **Orange**
 - Yellow + Blue = **Green**
 - Blue + Red = **Violet (Purple)**
- **TERTIARY COLOURS:** Made by mixing a primary and a secondary colour (e.g., Red-Orange, Yellow-Green).

COLOUR APPLICATION:

- **WASH:** Applying a thin, transparent layer of paint (common in watercolour).

- **GLAZING:** Applying a thin, transparent layer of paint *over* a dry layer to modify the colour.
- **WET-ON-WET:** Applying new paint to a layer of paint that is still wet, causing the colours to blend and bleed.
- **DRY BRUSH:** Using a brush with very little paint on it to create a scratchy, textured effect.

EVALUATION

1. What is the difference between "Fresco" and "Mural" painting?
2. Define the "Impasto" technique.
3. What traditional binder is used in Tempera paint?
4. List the three Primary Colours.
5. What do you get if you mix Blue and Red?

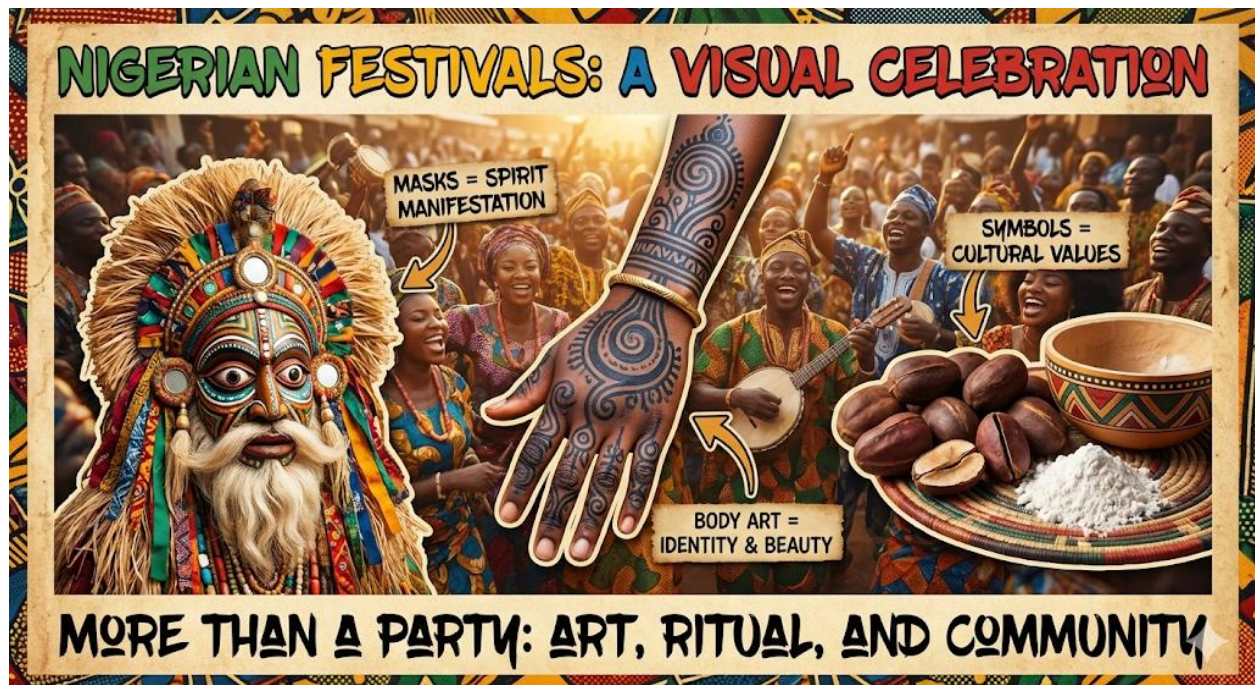
ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a simple colour wheel on paper.
2. Using poster colours or watercolours, paint the three Primary Colours and the three Secondary Colours in their correct positions on the wheel.
3. Create a small painting of a single natural object (e.g., a leaf or a flower) and practice applying at least two different colours.

WEEK 3: NIGERIAN CULTURAL FESTIVALS

3.1 MEANING AND ORIGIN OF FESTIVALS

A **cultural festival** is a large-scale, periodic (e.g., annual) celebration by a community. It is a time for the community to express and reaffirm its shared religious, social, and historical identity.



ORIGINS: Most Nigerian festivals originate from one of these three sources:

1. **RELIGION:** To honour or appease a specific deity or spirit (e.g., the *Osun-Osogbo* festival for the river goddess Osun).
2. **AGRICULTURE:** To celebrate a key moment in the farming calendar, most commonly the *New Yam Festival (Iri Ji)*, which marks the end of the old season and the harvest of the new yams.
3. **HISTORY:** To commemorate a significant event in the community's past, such as a great migration, victory in war, or the founding of the town (e.g., the *Ofala* festival in Onitsha, which celebrates the Oba's reign).

3.2 TYPES AND FUNCTIONS OF FESTIVALS

- **TYPES:** Religious, Harvest (Agricultural), Historical, Coming-of-Age, and Royal festivals.
- **FUNCTIONS:**
 1. **Social:** To unite the community, bringing people home from far away. It reinforces social bonds.
 2. **Religious:** To perform rituals that ensure the spiritual well-being, fertility, and prosperity of the land and its people.
 3. **Political:** To reaffirm the authority of the traditional ruler (Oba, Emir, Obi) and the social structure.
 4. **Economic:** To serve as a major market day and a tourist attraction, bringing wealth to the community.
 5. **Educational:** To pass down the community's history, myths, and values to the next generation through song, dance, and storytelling.

3.3 THE VISUAL ARTS IN FESTIVALS (SYMBOLS & DECORATIONS)

Festivals are a total art form, combining music, dance, and visual art.

- **SYMBOLIC SIGNIFICANCE:** The art objects used are not just "decorations"; they are symbols with deep meaning. A mask isn't just a mask; it is the *physical manifestation* of an ancestral spirit or a deity.
- **MASKS & MASQUERADES:** These are central to many festivals. The masquerader (*Egungun, Mmanwu*) loses their personal identity and becomes an "other-worldly" being. The masks themselves are often powerful works of sculpture.
- **BODY DECORATIONS:**
 - **Body Painting:** Using natural pigments (like chalk *efun*, *uli* ink, *camwood* *osun*) to draw symbolic patterns on the skin.
 - **Adornments:** Special costumes, beads, jewellery, and headgear that identify a person's role, status, or spiritual state.
- **ILLUSTRATION OF FESTIVAL SYMBOLS:** Symbols seen in festivals often represent core community values:
 - **Kola Nut:** Represents hospitality, peace, and agreement.

- **Palm Frond (*Mariwo*):** Represents sacredness, protection, and power.
- **White Chalk (*Nzu* or *Efun*):** Represents purity, peace, and good fortune.

EVALUATION

1. What is a cultural festival?
2. List the three main origins of most Nigerian festivals.
3. State four functions of a festival.
4. What is the symbolic difference between a "mask" and a "masquerader"?
5. What does white chalk (*efun/nzu*) symbolize in many Nigerian cultures?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Research one specific Nigerian festival (e.g., *Argungu Fishing Festival*, *Durbar Festival*, *Eyo Festival*, *New Yam Festival*).
2. Write one page about it, focusing on the visual arts: What do people wear? What masks or objects are used? What body decorations are seen?
3. Draw and colour two specific symbols or art objects from the festival you researched.

WEEK 4: HISTORY OF ART (AFRICAN TRADITIONAL ART)

4.1 INTRODUCTION TO TRADITIONAL AFRICAN ART

Traditional African Art refers to the diverse range of objects and practices produced by the peoples of sub-Saharan Africa before significant European influence.



GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS:

- **FUNCTIONAL:** The art was not made for "art's sake." It was made for a *purpose*—religious, social, or political. A mask was made to be *danced*, a stool was made for a *king*, a pot was made for *storage*.
- **SPIRITUAL:** Most art objects were connected to the spiritual world, used in rituals, or meant to honour ancestors and deities.
- **STYLISTIC VARIETY:** There is no single "African" style. Art from the forest (e.g., wooden masks) is very different from art from the savanna.
- **MEDIA (MATERIALS):** Artists used locally available materials: wood, clay (terracotta), metal (iron, brass, bronze), ivory, stone, beads, and textiles.

4.2 ART FORMS OF WEST & CENTRAL AFRICA

(The scheme lists "Guinea, Kiss, Cameroon, Dahomey, Sierra Leone." Kissi are a people within Guinea/Sierra Leone).

1. GUINEA / SIERRA LEONE (MENDE, KISSI, BAGA PEOPLES):

- **Focus:** Art here is known for its masks and stone figures.
- **Mende people (Sierra Leone):** Famous for the *Sowei* or *Bundu* mask, a helmet-mask worn by women in the *Sande* society. It is known for its high-gloss black finish, ringed neck (representing fertility/health), and complex hairstyles.
- **Kissi people (Guinea/Sierra Leone):** Known for *Nomoli* figures, small soapstone (steatite) statues that are ancient and often found by farmers. They are used in shrines to promote crop fertility.
- **Baga people (Guinea):** Known for massive, shoulder-worn masks like the *Nimba*, which represents the "mother of fertility."

2. DAHOMEY (FON PEOPLE, MODERN REPUBLIC OF BENIN):

- **Focus:** Art was primarily for the powerful Fon kings.
- **Royal Arts:** Highly decorative and symbolic. Kings were associated with specific animals (e.g., King Glele with the lion).
- **Bocio Figures:** "Power figures" created by priests. They are intentionally rough and crude, combining materials like wood, rope, and medicinal packets to activate spiritual power for protection or to harm enemies.
- **Appliqué Banners:** Large, colourful banners that tell stories of kings and historical events.

3. CAMEROON (GRASSLANDS - BAMILEKE & BAMUM PEOPLES):

- **Focus:** Art is exuberant, bold, and often covered in beads.
- **Media:** Wood, beads, brass, and textiles are all used lavishly.
- **Royal Arts:** Lavish thrones, stools, and architectural sculptures for the king (*Fon*).
- **Masks:** Famous for the "Elephant Mask" (*Mbap Mteng*), a large, elaborate beaded mask with elephantine ears and trunk, worn by the *Kuosi* warrior society.

4.3 INFLUENCE ON MODERN ART

In the early 1900s, European artists like **Pablo Picasso** and **Henri Matisse** "discovered" African masks in Paris museums. They were shocked and inspired by the non-naturalistic, abstract, and powerful forms. This led to the birth of **Cubism** and changed the course of Western art forever.

EVALUATION

1. What does it mean to say Traditional African Art is "functional"?
2. What is a *Nomoli* figure, and what material is it made from?
3. The *Sowei* or *Bundu* mask of the Mende people is unique. Why? (Who wears it?)
4. Describe the key characteristics of Cameroon Grasslands art.
5. What European art movement was directly inspired by African masks?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose ONE of the three regions discussed (Guinea/Sierra Leone, Dahomey, or Cameroon).
2. Draw a representative art object from that region (e.g., a *Sowei* mask, a *Bocio* figure, or an *Elephant* mask).
3. Write a short paragraph next to your drawing explaining what the object is and what it was used for.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

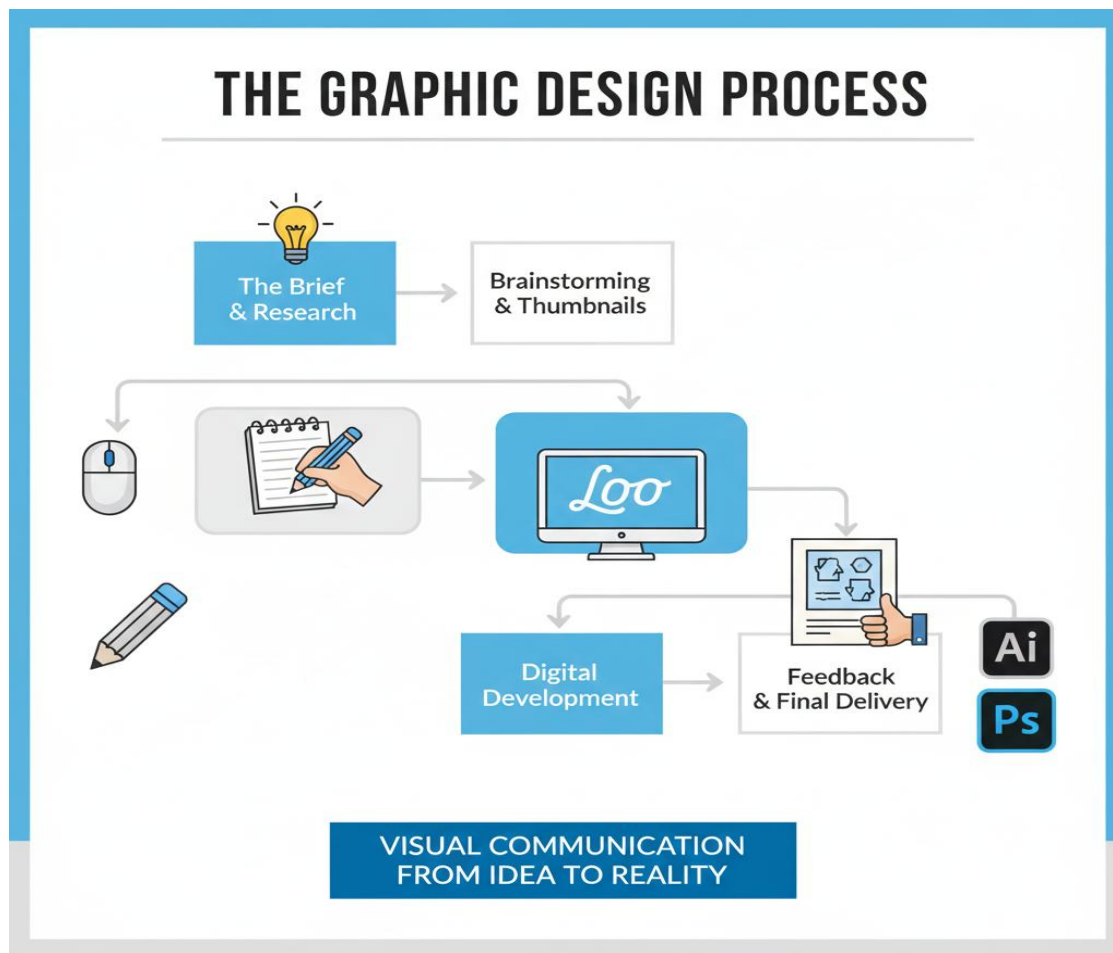
(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: GRAPHIC DESIGN

6.1 DEFINITION AND TYPES OF GRAPHIC DESIGN

GRAPHIC DESIGN is the art and profession of **visual communication and problem-solving** using typography (text), photography, and illustration. It is the process of creating visual content to communicate a message to a specific audience.



TYPES (APPLICATIONS) OF GRAPHIC DESIGN:

- **Branding / Identity Design:** Creating the "face" of a company. This includes:
 - **Logo Design:** The central, identifiable symbol of a brand.
- **Publication Design:** The layout of magazines, newspapers, and books.

- **Book Cover / Book Jacket Design:** Creating the front and back covers to attract readers.
- **Advertising & Marketing Design:**
 - **Poster Design:** A large visual print designed to communicate a message quickly (e.g., for an event, movie, or public announcement).
 - **Flyers & Brochures.**
- **Packaging Design:** Designing the container of a product. This must be attractive, provide information, and protect the product.
- **Information Design:** Presenting complex information clearly and easily (e.g., signboards, infographics, calendars).
- **Digital Design:** Creating visuals for websites, social media, and apps.

6.2 TOOLS AND MATERIALS

- **TRADITIONAL:** Pencils, pens, paper, drawing boards, rulers, markers, cutting knives.
- **MODERN (DIGITAL):**
 - **Hardware:** A computer (desktop or laptop), a graphics tablet (like a Wacom), and a scanner.
 - **Software:** The industry-standard software includes **Adobe Illustrator** (for vector-based logos and illustrations) and **Adobe Photoshop** (for image editing and photo manipulation). **CorelDRAW** is also very popular.

6.3 CALLIGRAPHY

Calligraphy is the art of "**beautiful writing.**" It is different from *lettering* (which is *drawing* letters) and *typography* (which is *arranging* pre-designed fonts). Calligraphy is a skilled, fluid writing practice using special pens or brushes to create expressive, decorative letterforms. It is often used in wedding invitations, certificates, and formal documents.

6.4 PRACTICAL DESIGNS (THE DESIGN PROCESS)

Whether designing a logo, poster, or book cover, a graphic designer follows a process:

1. **THE BRIEF:** Understand the client's needs, the message, and the target audience.
2. **RESEARCH:** Look at competitors and gather inspiration.
3. **BRAINSTORMING / SKETCHING:** Create "thumbnails" (small, rough sketches) of many different ideas.
4. **DEVELOPMENT (DIGITAL):** Choose the best sketches and create digital versions ("comps" or "mockups") using software.
5. **FEEDBACK & REVISION:** Show the client, get feedback, and make changes.
6. **FINAL DELIVERY:** Prepare the final files for printing or web use.

EVALUATION

1. What is the primary goal of graphic design?
2. Differentiate between a logo and a poster.
3. List two traditional tools and two digital tools used by graphic designers.
4. What is the difference between calligraphy and typography?
5. What is the first and most important step in the graphic design process?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Choose a fictional product (e.g., "Zobo-Max Drink" or "Adesua's Biscuits").
2. On a sheet of paper, sketch three (3) different logo ideas for this product.
3. Then, design a **poster** for it. Your poster must include:
 - The Logo
 - The Product Name
 - A simple drawing of the product
 - A short slogan (e.g., "The Best Taste!")

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

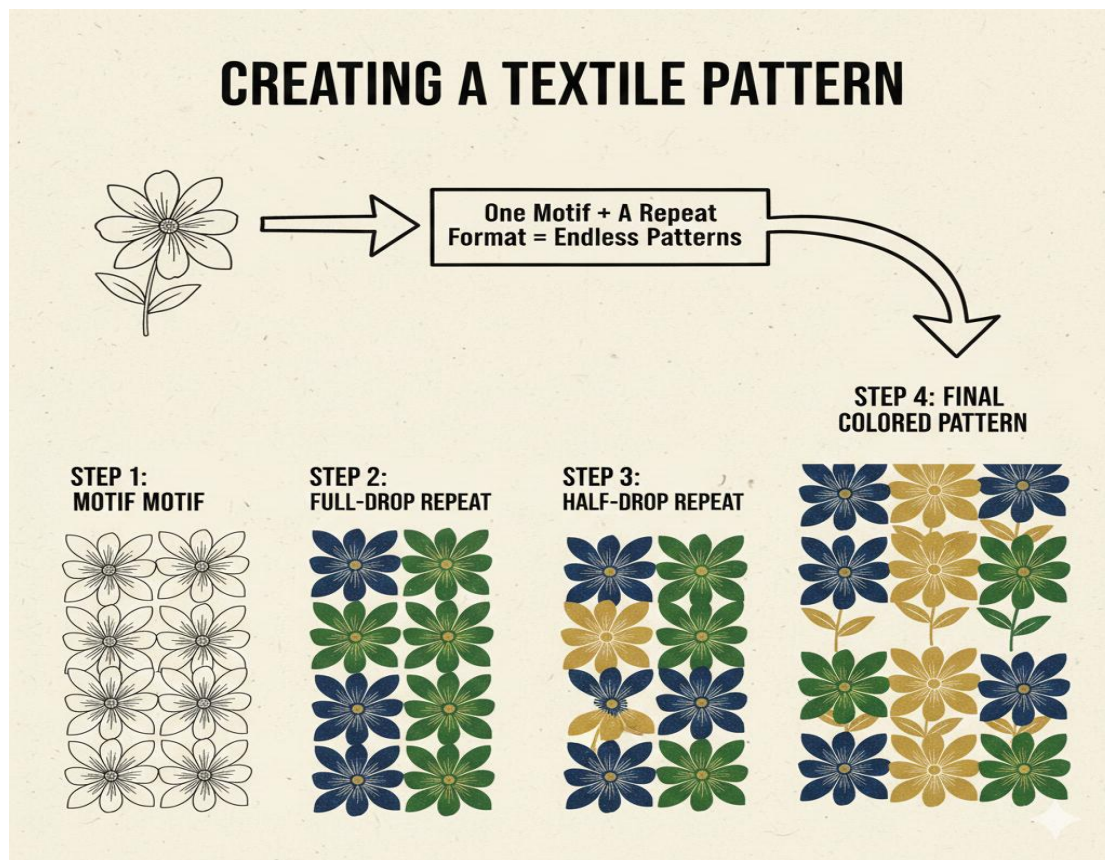
(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: TEXTILE DESIGN ON PAPER

8.1 INTRODUCTION TO TEXTILE DESIGN

Textile Design is the art of creating designs and patterns for fabrics. This process starts on **paper** (or a computer) before it is ever applied to cloth. The two main components of textile design are the **motif** and the **repeat**.



8.2 CREATION OF MOTIFS

A **motif** is the basic, single design element that is repeated to create a pattern. Motifs can be inspired by anything:

- **FLORAL**: Based on plants, leaves, and flowers.
- **GEOMETRIC**: Based on shapes (circles, squares, triangles, lines).

- **FIGURATIVE / STYLIZED:** Based on recognizable objects like animals, people, or symbols that have been simplified.
- **ABSTRACT:** Based on non-representational shapes, colours, and textures.

8.3 FORMATION OF REPEATING FORMATS (PATTERN LAYOUT)

The way a motif is repeated is called the **repeat format**. This is the structure that turns a single drawing into a seamless pattern.

1. **FULL DROP / BLOCK REPEAT:** The simplest repeat. The motif is placed in a simple grid, like blocks.
2. **HALF-DROP REPEAT:** The motif is repeated, but each new row is shifted *halfway down* from the previous row. This is more dynamic and hides the grid.
3. **BRICK REPEAT:** Similar to a half-drop, but the motif is shifted halfway *sideways*, like a brick wall.
4. **MIRROR REPEAT:** The motif is reflected horizontally or vertically, creating a symmetrical, "Rorschach" effect.
5. **TOSSED / RANDOM REPEAT:** Motifs are scattered, often at different angles, to look random (though it is still a planned repeat).

8.4 APPLICATION OF COLOURS ON PATTERNS

Colour is crucial for a textile design. When designing on paper, artists use coloured pencils, markers, or paint.

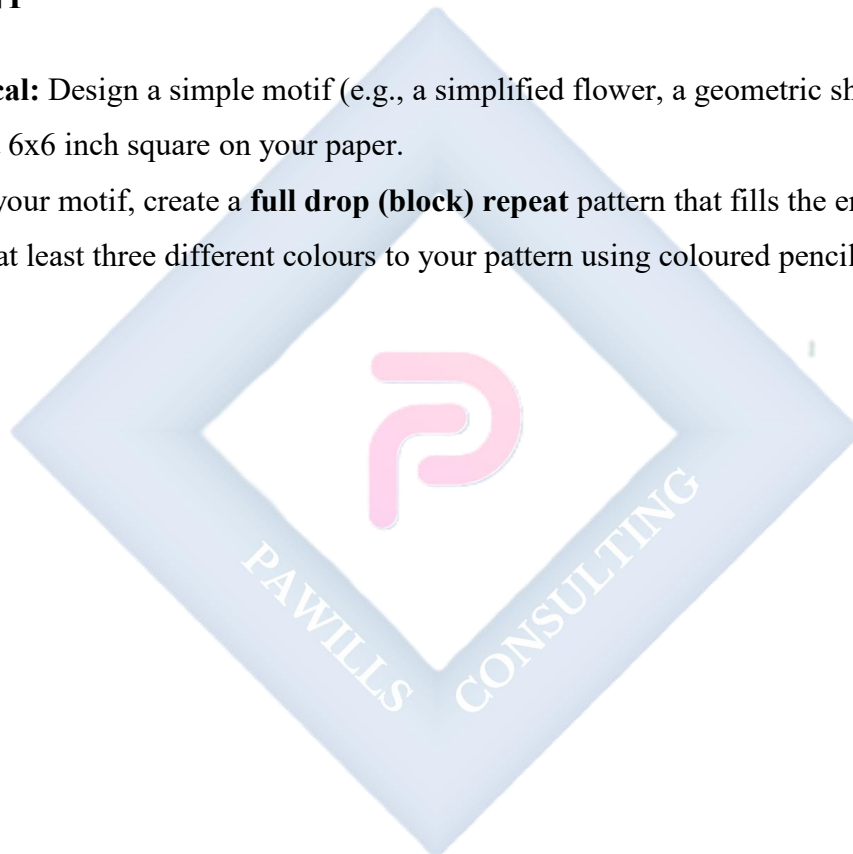
- **COLOUR PALETTE:** The designer first chooses a limited set of colours (a palette) that work well together.
- **HARMONY & CONTRAST:** The colours must create a pleasing harmony. Sometimes, a "spot colour" (a single bright colour) is used for contrast.
- **FILLING:** The designer must decide which parts of the motif will be which colour and what the background colour will be. The same pattern can look completely different with different colour choices.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "motif" in textile design?
2. List three common sources of inspiration for motifs.
3. What is the difference between a "full drop repeat" and a "half-drop repeat"?
4. What is a "mirror repeat"?
5. Why is choosing a "colour palette" important?

ASSIGNMENT

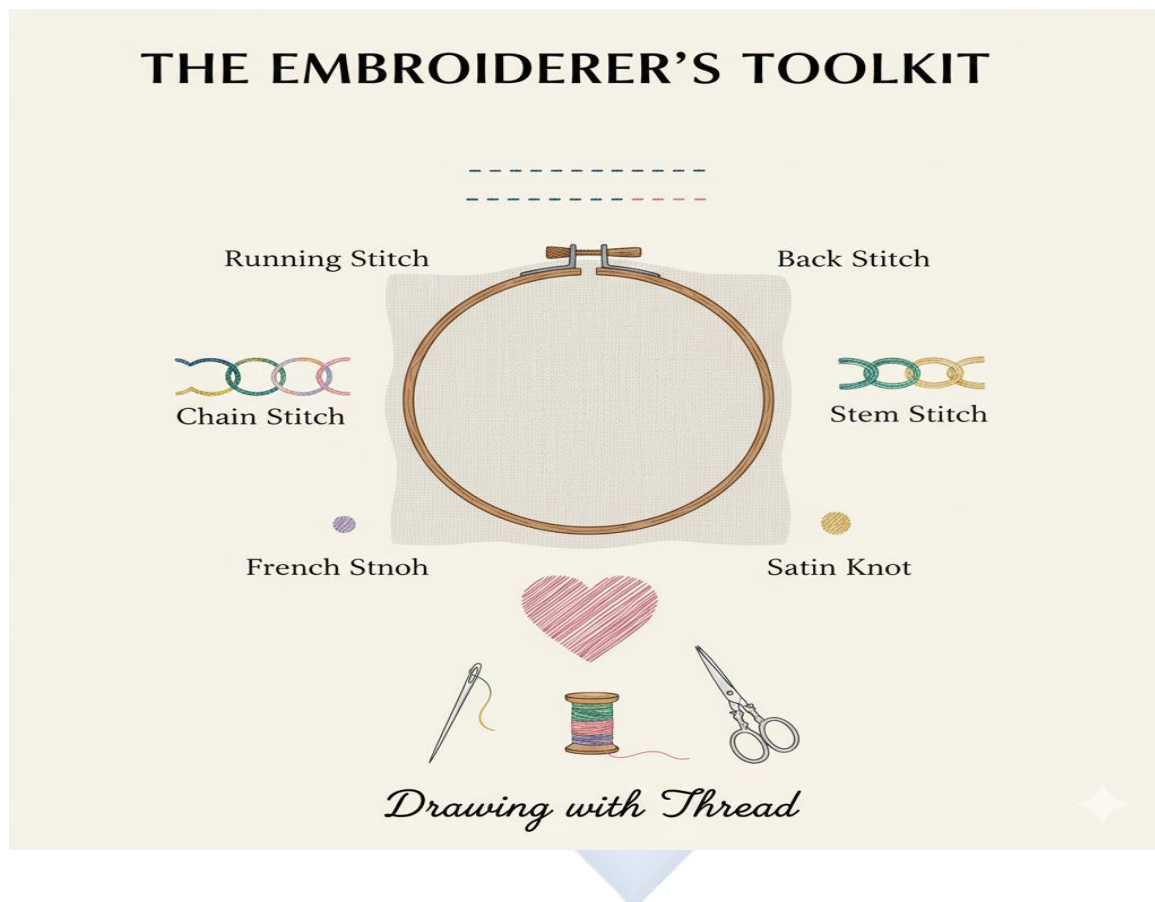
1. **Practical:** Design a simple motif (e.g., a simplified flower, a geometric shape).
2. Draw a 6x6 inch square on your paper.
3. Using your motif, create a **full drop (block) repeat** pattern that fills the entire square.
4. Apply at least three different colours to your pattern using coloured pencils or markers.



WEEK 9: EMBROIDERY

9.1 IDENTIFICATION OF EMBROIDERY WORKS

Embroidery is the art or craft of decorating fabric or other materials using a **needle and thread** (or yarn). It is "drawing with thread." Embroidery is used to add patterns, motifs, text, and rich texture to clothing (like *buba* and *agbada*), household items, and religious textiles.



9.2 TOOLS AND MATERIALS

- **NEEDLE:** The primary tool. They come in various sizes with different eye-shapes.
- **THREAD:** This can be embroidery floss (most common), cotton, silk, wool, or even metallic thread.
- **FABRIC:** The ground material to be stitched (e.g., cotton, linen, *aso-oke*).
- **EMBROIDERY HOOP:** A pair of rings that hold the fabric "taut" (tight) for even stitching.

- **SCISSORS:** A small, sharp pair for trimming thread.
- **STITCHING MACHINE:** Modern embroidery is often done with computerized sewing machines that can create complex patterns very quickly.

9.3 ILLUSTRATION OF EMBROIDERY STITCHES

There are hundreds of stitches, but most embroidery is based on a few key ones.

- **RUNNING STITCH:** The most basic stitch. A simple in-and-out line.
- **BACK STITCH:** A strong, solid line stitch, perfect for outlining.
- **STEM STITCH:** A twisted, rope-like stitch, good for outlines and curved lines (like flower stems).
- **CHAIN STITCH:** A series of looped stitches that form a "chain." Used for bold outlines or filling.
- **SATIN STITCH:** A series of long, parallel stitches placed close together to *fill* a shape with a solid, "satin" block of colour.
- **FRENCH KNOT:** A small, decorative knot made by twisting the thread around the needle, used for details like eyes or flower centres.

9.4 TRANSFER OF STITCHES ONTO FABRIC

You must get your design from the paper *onto* the fabric before you can stitch.

1. **TRACING:** Using a light-box or a sunny window to see the design through the fabric and trace it with a special fabric pencil.
2. **TRANSFER PAPER:** A type of dressmaker's carbon paper is placed between the design and the fabric. You trace the design, and the pressure transfers the lines.
3. **IRON-ON TRANSFER:** Some patterns can be bought or printed on special paper that transfers the design to the fabric using a hot iron.

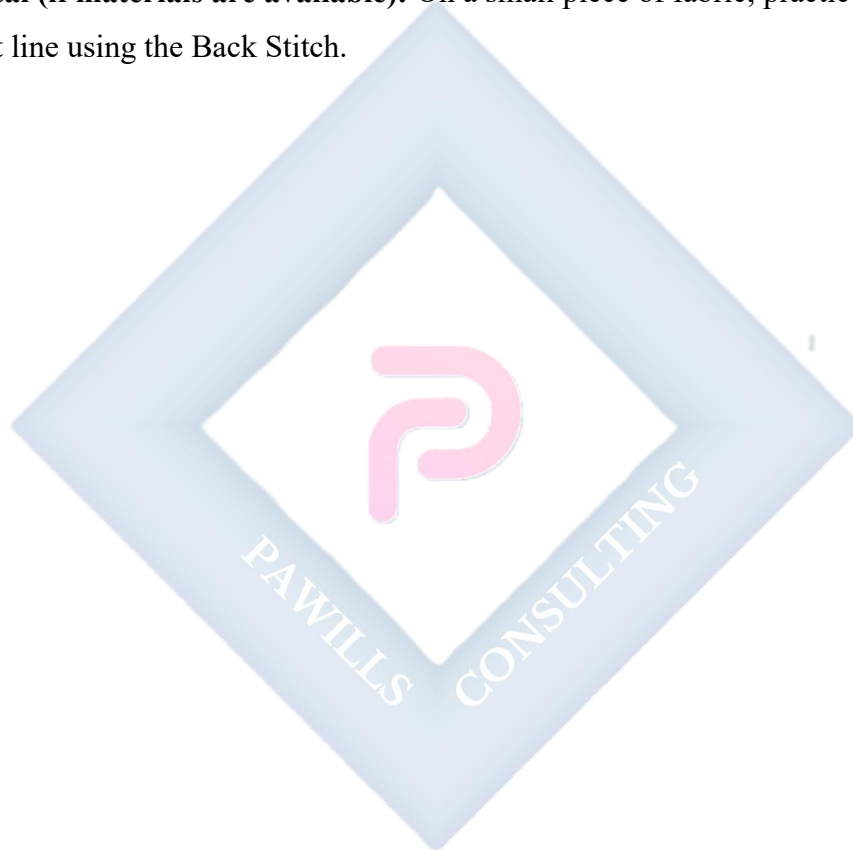
EVALUATION

1. Define embroidery.
2. What is the purpose of an embroidery hoop?

3. What is the difference between a "Back Stitch" and a "Running Stitch"?
4. Which stitch is best for *filling* a shape with solid colour?
5. Name one method for transferring a design from paper to fabric.

ASSIGNMENT

1. On a sheet of paper, *draw* (do not stitch) the following five stitches: Running Stitch, Back Stitch, Stem Stitch, Chain Stitch, and Satin Stitch.
2. **Practical (if materials are available):** On a small piece of fabric, practice making a straight line using the Back Stitch.



WEEK 10: FURNITURE MAKING

10.1 INTRODUCTION AND FUNCTIONS OF FURNITURE

Furniture refers to movable objects designed to support various human activities or hold objects. Furniture helps make a space (like a house, office, or school) functional and comfortable.

FROM TREE TO TABLE



FUNCTIONS OF FURNITURE:

- **SEATING:** For sitting or resting (e.g., chairs, stools, benches, sofas).
- **STORAGE:** For keeping and organizing items (e.g., cabinets, wardrobes, shelves, chests of drawers).
- **SURFACES:** To provide a flat, raised surface for work, eating, or display (e.g., tables, desks, counters).
- **REST:** For sleeping or reclining (e.g., beds, mats).

10.2 SOURCING AND TREATMENT OF WOOD

- **SOURCING WOOD:** The most common material for furniture is **wood**. In Nigeria, popular hardwoods include **Iroko, Mahogany, Obeche, and Teak**. Hardwoods are durable but expensive. Softwoods (like Pine) are cheaper but less durable.
- **WOOD TREATMENT (SEASONING):** Wood cannot be used immediately after a tree is cut. It is "green" and full of moisture (sap). It must be **seasoned** (dried) first.
- **WHY SEASON?** If you use "green" wood, it will **warp, twist, crack, and shrink** as it dries, destroying the furniture.
- **METHODS OF SEASONING:**
 1. **Air Drying:** Stacking the wood in a specific way to allow air to circulate around it. This is slow (can take years) but cheap.
 2. **Kiln Drying:** Placing the wood in a large, heated oven (a kiln) to dry it quickly and precisely. This is fast but expensive.

10.3 PROCESSES INVOLVED IN FURNITURE MAKING

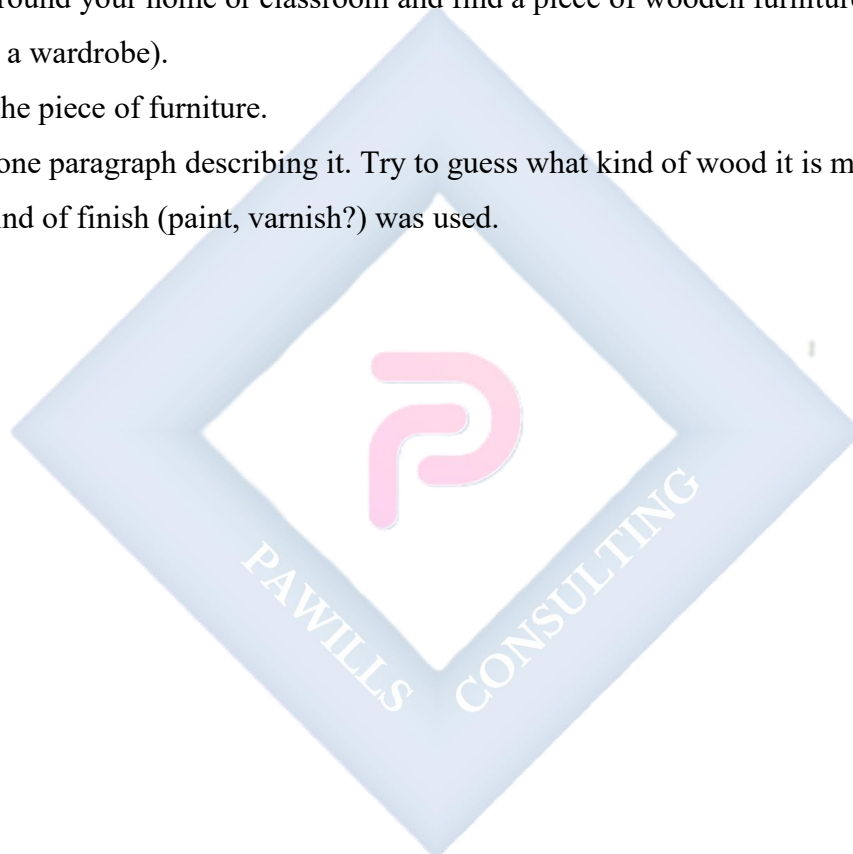
1. **DESIGN:** The first step. This is a detailed drawing (technical drawing) of the furniture, showing its exact size, shape, and parts.
2. **DIMENSIONING / MARKING:** The designer transfers the measurements from the drawing onto the raw wood using a pencil, ruler, and try square.
3. **CUTTING & SHAPING:** The wood is cut to size using saws (handsaw, circular saw).
4. **ASSEMBLY (JOINERY):** This is the most skilled part. The pieces are joined together.
 - Simple joins: Nails, screws, glue.
 - Advanced **Joinery:** Creating interlocking joints in the wood itself (e.g., **Dovetail joints, Mortise and Tenon joints**). These are very strong.
5. **FINISHING:** The final stage. The piece is **sanded** to make it smooth. Then, a finish is applied to protect the wood and make it look good.
 - **Staining:** Adds colour to the wood.
 - **Varnishing / Lacquering:** Adds a hard, clear, protective, and often glossy coat.
 - **Painting:** Covers the wood with an opaque colour.

EVALUATION

1. List the four main functions of furniture.
2. Name two hardwoods commonly used for furniture in Nigeria.
3. What is "seasoning," and why is it essential before using wood?
4. What is the difference between Air Drying and Kiln Drying?
5. What is "joinery"? Name one type of advanced joint.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Look around your home or classroom and find a piece of wooden furniture (e.g., a chair, a table, a wardrobe).
2. **Draw** the piece of furniture.
3. **Write** one paragraph describing it. Try to guess what kind of wood it is made from and what kind of finish (paint, varnish?) was used.



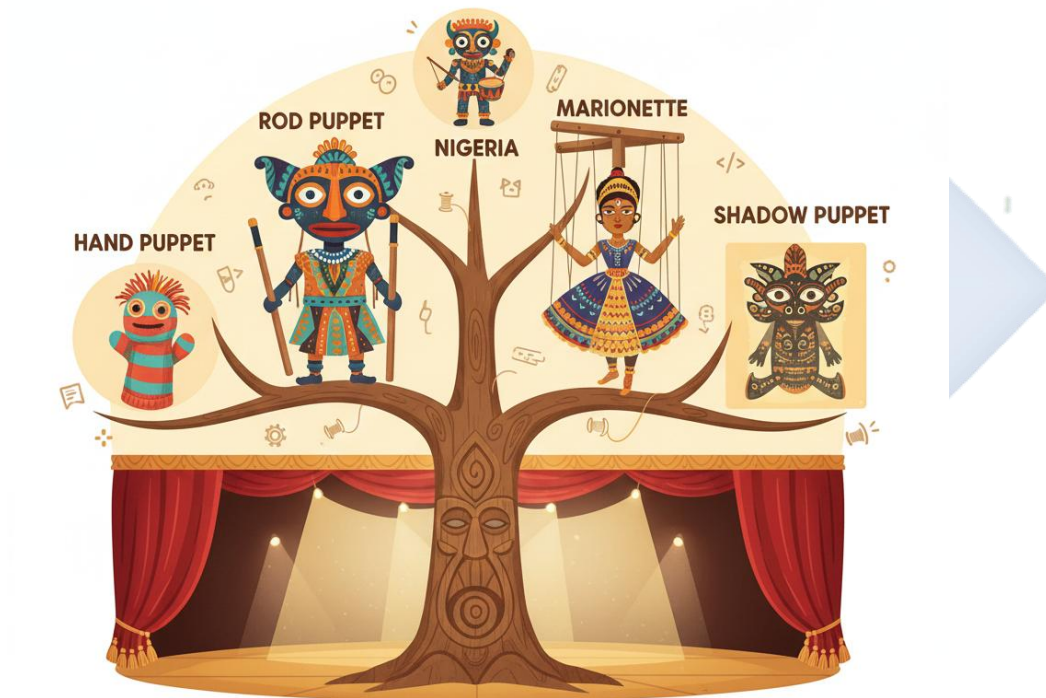
WEEK 11: PUPPETRY

11.1 MEANING AND TYPES OF PUPPETS

Puppetry is a form of theatre or performance that involves the manipulation of **puppets**—inanimate objects that are brought to life by a person called a **puppeteer**. The puppeteer's hand is usually hidden to create the illusion that the object is alive.

THE WORLD OF PUPPETRY

Bringing Inanimate Objects to Life



TYPES OF PUPPETS:

1. **HAND (GLOVE) PUPPET:** The puppeteer's hand goes inside the puppet. The fingers control the head and arms. (e.g., "Punch and Judy," *Sesame Street*'s Elmo).
2. **ROD PUPPET:** The puppet's head and limbs are controlled from below by long, thin rods. (e.g., *Sesame Street*'s Kermit the Frog).

3. **MARIONETTE (STRING PUPPET):** A full-bodied puppet controlled from *above* by a "control" (a wooden cross) connected to the puppet by strings. These are complex to make and use.
4. **SHADOW PUPPET:** A flat, cut-out figure that is pressed against a translucent screen. A light from behind projects a shadow, which the audience sees. (Famous in Indonesia - *Wayang Kulit*).
5. **FINGER PUPPET:** A very simple puppet that fits over a single finger.

11.2 TOOLS, MATERIALS, AND CONSTRUCTION

- **TOOLS:** Needles, thread, scissors, glue gun, saws, craft knives.
- **MATERIALS:**
 - **Fabric, Felt, Socks:** For the "skin" or body of hand puppets.
 - **Cardboard, Wood, Polystyrene:** For the structure of the head.
 - **Paint, Markers, Wool (for hair), Buttons (for eyes):** For decoration.
- **CONSTRUCTION:**
 - **Seams and Stitches:** Basic hand-sewing stitches (like the running stitch) are used to join the fabric pieces to create the puppet's body (glove).
 - The head is often made separately (e.g., a paper-mâché or foam ball) and then attached to the fabric body.

11.3 NIGERIAN PUPPETRY

Puppetry is not just a Western or Asian art form; it has a long and rich history in Nigeria.

- **FORMS & STYLES:** Nigerian puppetry is almost always part of a larger **masquerade performance** that includes music and dance. The puppets are often part of a large structure carried on the masquerader's head.
- **EXAMPLES:**
 - **Kwagh-hir (Tiv People):** A very famous and elaborate form of "storytelling theatre." It uses a combination of masquerades and large, complex puppets (both rod and hand) to tell stories about history, morality, and social satire.

- **Ekon Puppetry (Ibibio People):** Used in rituals, these puppets are often part of a "stage" carried on the head, with figures moved by rods and strings.
- **FUNCTIONS:** Like festivals, Nigerian puppetry is not just for *entertainment*. It is used for:
 - **Social Commentary & Satire:** To make fun of or criticize powerful people.
 - **Storytelling:** To pass down oral history and myths.
 - **Ritual:** To be used in religious or funeral ceremonies.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "puppeteer"?
2. What is the main difference between a Hand Puppet and a Marionette?
3. What is a Shadow Puppet, and how does it work?
4. Name one famous Nigerian puppetry tradition.
5. List two functions of traditional Nigerian puppetry, other than entertainment.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Create a simple **finger puppet** or **sock puppet** (a type of hand puppet) using an old sock.
2. Find materials at home (e.g., buttons, wool, markers, paper cut-outs) and glue or sew them onto the sock to create a face and hair.
3. Give your puppet a name.

WEEK 12: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the first term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-11 in preparation for the First Term Examination.)

- **KEY TOPICS FOR REVIEW:**

- **Drawing:** Shading techniques (Hatching, Stippling, Blending) and types (Still Life, Nature).
- **Painting:** Techniques (Impasto, Fresco, Tempera), Colour Theory (Primary/Secondary).
- **Cultural Festivals:** Functions (Social, Religious), and the role of art (Masks, Body Decoration).
- **History of Art:** Characteristics of Traditional African Art; Art of Cameroon, Dahomey, and Sierra Leone (Mende, Kissi).
- **Graphic Design:** Types (Logo, Poster, Packaging), Tools, and the Design Process.
- **Textile Design:** Motifs and Repeat Formats (Half-drop, Full-drop).
- **Embroidery:** Types of Stitches (Satin, Chain, Back Stitch) and Tools.
- **Furniture Making:** Wood Seasoning (Air vs. Kiln) and the 5 Processes (Design, Dimensioning, Assembly, etc.).
- **Puppetry:** Types (Hand, Marionette, Shadow) and Nigerian forms (*Kwagh-hir*).

SS2 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

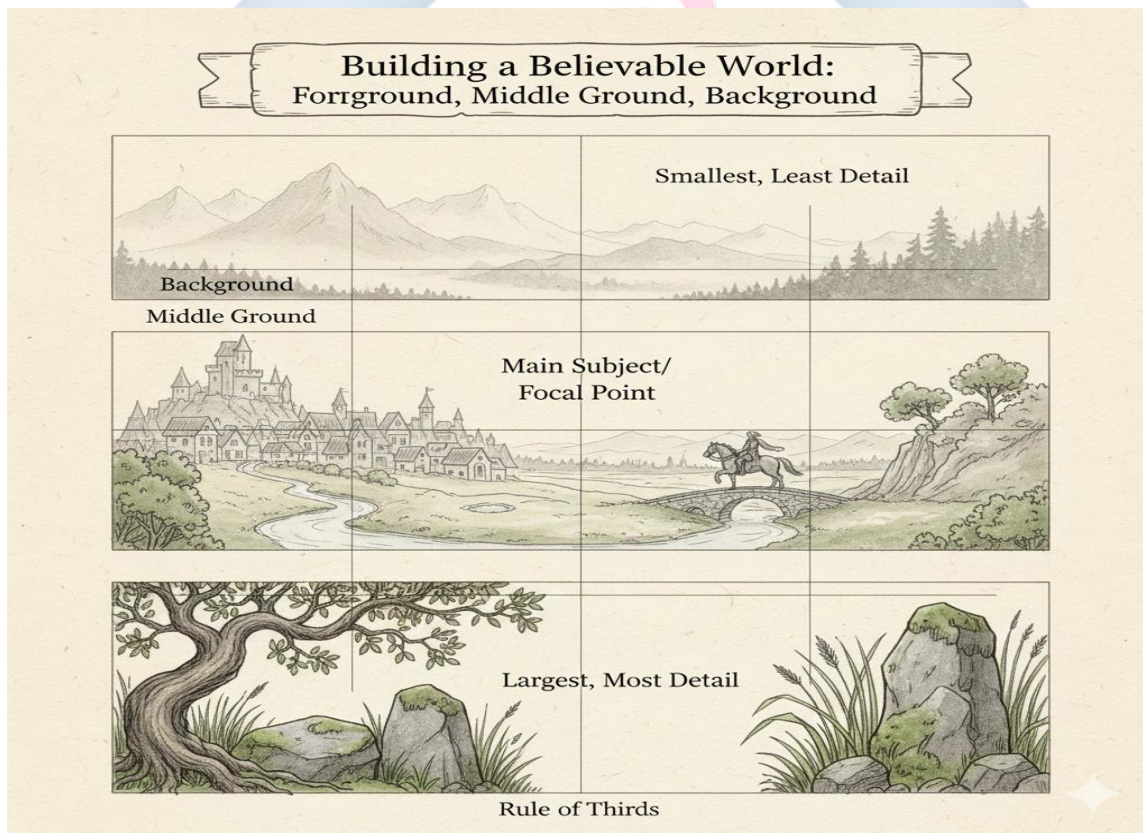
SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION I

1.1 MEANING OF IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION

Imaginative Composition is the art of creating a drawing or painting from the artist's own mind, rather than by observing a real-life object or scene. It involves arranging various elements (people, objects, landscapes) that may or may not exist in reality to form a new, original, and unified picture.

It is a test of the artist's creativity, memory, and understanding of the principles of art. It's not just "drawing from imagination"; it is the *thoughtful arrangement* (composition) of imagined elements to tell a story or create a mood.



1.2 THE COMPONENTS OF COMPOSITION (CREATING DEPTH)

To make an imaginative scene look realistic and three-dimensional, the artist must create an illusion of *depth*. This is done by dividing the picture into "planes."

- **1. FOREGROUND:**

- **What it is:** The area of the picture that appears *closest* to the viewer.
- **Characteristics:** Objects in the foreground are drawn the **largest**. They have the **most detail**, the **sharpest focus**, and the **strongest contrast** (deepest darks and brightest lights).
- **Function:** It serves as an "entry point" into the picture, leading the viewer's eye into the scene.
- *Example: In a market scene, the foreground might be a large, detailed basket of yams at the viewer's feet.*

- **2. MIDDLE GROUND:**

- **What it is:** The area in the middle of the picture, between the foreground and background.
- **Characteristics:** This is typically where the main action or subject is placed. Objects are smaller than in the foreground and have slightly less detail and contrast.
- **Function:** It holds the main story of the composition.
- *Example: The middle ground is where you see the market women, their stalls, and the people haggling.*

- **3. BACKGROUND:**

- **What it is:** The area of the picture that appears *farthest* from the viewer.
- **Characteristics:** Objects are the **smallest** and have the **least detail**. Colours are often lighter, cooler (bluer), and more faded. This effect is called **Atmospheric Perspective**.
- **Function:** It provides context, location, and a sense of "world" to the scene.
- *Example: The background would be distant buildings, trees, or the sky.*

1.3 AREA OF INTEREST (THE FOCAL POINT)

The **Area of Interest**, or **Focal Point**, is the *most important part* of the composition. It is the specific spot where the artist wants the viewer's eye to go *first*. A good composition has a clear focal point, while a weak one makes the viewer's eye wander aimlessly.

How to create a Focal Point:

- **Contrast:** Placing the lightest light next to the darkest dark.
- **Placement:** Using the "Rule of Thirds."
- **Isolation:** Placing the main subject in an open space.
- **Leading Lines:** Using lines (like roads, rivers, or a pointed finger) to guide the viewer's eye directly to it.

1.4 COMPOSITIONAL ARRANGEMENT OF OBJECTS (THE RULES)

Arrangement is the *planning* stage. The main principles to follow are:

1. THE RULE OF THIRDS:

- Imagine your paper is divided into a 3x3 grid (like a Noughts and Crosses board).
- The most important compositional elements (like the focal point) should be placed on or near the **four intersecting points** of this grid, not in the dead centre. This creates a more dynamic and natural-feeling composition.

2. BALANCE: The composition must feel visually stable.

- **Symmetrical Balance:** (Formal) One side is a mirror image of the other. Feels calm, stable, and rigid.
- **Asymmetrical Balance:** (Informal) The two sides are different but have equal "visual weight" (e.g., one large object on the left is balanced by two small objects on the right). Feels more dynamic and modern.

3. UNITY AND HARMONY: All the parts of the picture must look like they *belong* together. This is achieved through a consistent style, colour palette, and light source.

4. LEADING LINES: Using elements within the picture (roads, fences, rivers, the gaze of a person) to direct the viewer's eye around the painting, usually towards the focal point.

5. **AVOID TANGENTS:** Do not let objects just "kiss" or touch at the edges, as it creates visual confusion. Either overlap them or leave a clear space.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "Imaginative Composition" and "Still Life Drawing"?
2. List the three "planes" used to create depth in a composition.
3. What are two characteristics of objects in the *background*?
4. Explain the "Rule of Thirds."
5. What is an "Area of Interest" or "Focal Point"?

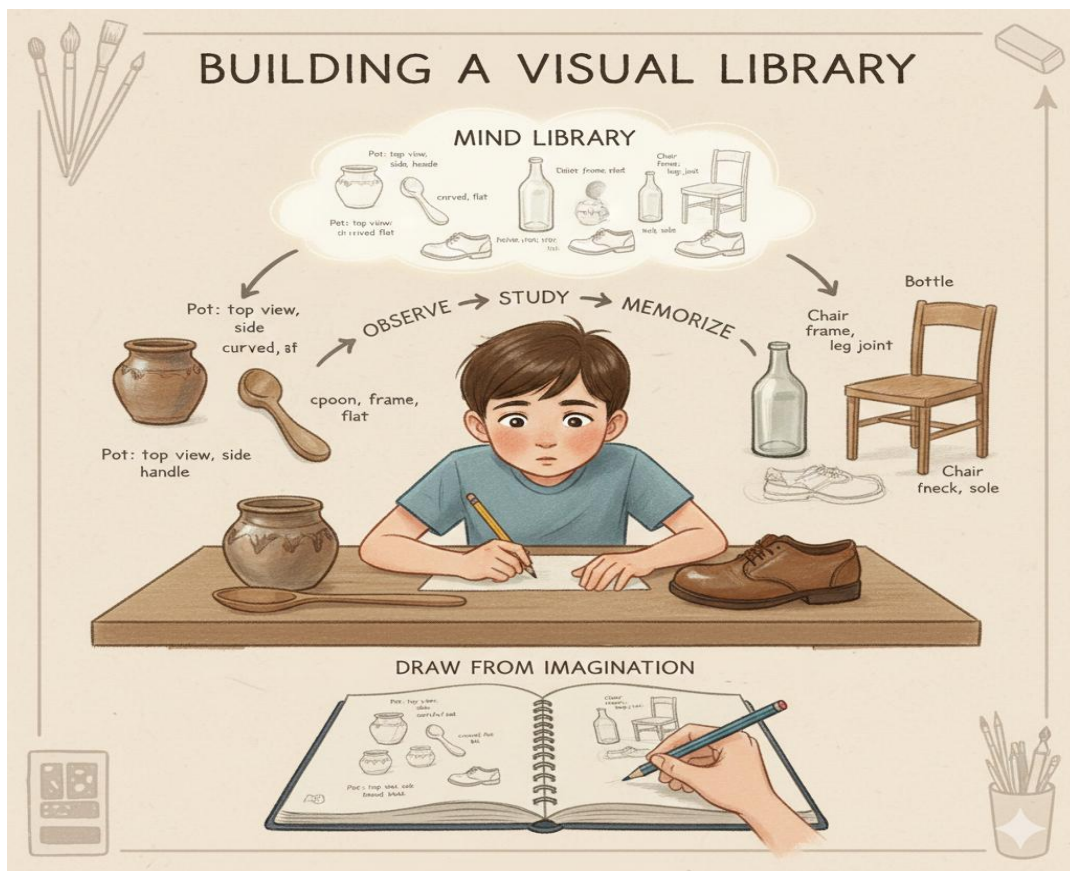
ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose a simple theme (e.g., "A Rainy Day" or "At the Bus Stop").
2. On a single sheet of paper, draw *three* small "thumbnail sketches" (no larger than your palm).
3. For each sketch, try a *different* arrangement. In one, place the focal point in the centre. In another, place it using the Rule of Thirds.
4. Label the Foreground, Middle Ground, and Background on your *best* sketch.

WEEK 2: IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION II

2.1 BUILDING A "VISUAL LIBRARY"

To draw from imagination, you must first build a "visual library" in your mind. You cannot draw what you do not know. The *only* way to draw a pot, spoon, or chair from your imagination is to have first *intensely studied* real pots, spoons, and chairs.



Drawing Objects from Imagination:

- This is an exercise in *visual memory* and *structural understanding*.
- You must learn to see complex objects as simple 3D forms:
 - A **pot** is a sphere or a cylinder.
 - A **house** is a cube (or cuboid) with a triangular prism (the roof).
 - A **spoon** is a shallow hemisphere (the bowl) and a flat rectangle (the handle).

- By practicing drawing these simple forms in perspective (making them look 3D), you can construct any object from your imagination.

2.2 SKETCHING SCENES FROM MEMORY

This is more complex because it involves combining multiple objects and capturing a *mood* or *feeling*.

Case Study: Sketching a "Market Scene"

1. **Brainstorming (Thumbnails):** You don't start with a big drawing. You start with tiny, fast "thumbnail sketches" to test ideas. What is the *essence* of a market? Chaos, crowds, haggling, bright colours.
2. **Establish Composition:** Apply last week's rules.
 - **Focal Point:** A woman haggling with a seller.
 - **Foreground:** A large basket of peppers, slightly out of focus.
 - **Middle Ground:** The focal point (the two women) and their stalls.
 - **Background:** A blurry crowd, distant stalls, and rooftops.
3. **Use Gesture Drawing:** Don't try to draw perfect, detailed people. Use quick, loose "gesture lines" to capture the *pose* and *movement* of the crowd. This makes the scene feel alive.
4. **Populate the Scene:** Add other details from your "visual library" (pots, yams, textiles, umbrellas) to make the scene believable.

2.3 APPLICATION OF COLOUR AND SHADING

In imaginative composition, the artist must *invent* the light and colour.

Application of Shading (Creating Form):

- **Establish a Light Source:** The first and most important rule. You must *decide* where the "sun" or "light bulb" is in your scene.
- **Consistent Shading:** *Every single object* in your scene must be shaded according to that one light source.

- If the sun is on the left, *all* objects must have their shadows on the right.
- This consistency is what "sells" the illusion and makes the imaginary scene look real.
- Techniques (from 1st Term) like cross-hatching, blending, and stippling are used to build up these invented shadows.

Application of Colour (Creating Mood):

- Colour choice is used to tell the story and create the *emotional atmosphere*.
- **Market Scene:** You would use bright, warm, and highly saturated colours (Reds, Yellows, Oranges) to show the heat, energy, and excitement.
- **Motor Accident Scene:** You might use dark, somber, and *desaturated* colours (Greys, dark Blues, deep Reds) to create a mood of sadness, danger, and confusion.
- **Colour Harmony:** You must still choose a palette of colours that work well together (e.g., complementary, analogous) to keep the image unified.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "visual library," and how do you build one?
2. What is the first and most important rule for applying shading to an imaginative scene?
3. How does the use of colour differ in painting a "Market Scene" versus a "Motor Accident Scene"?
4. What is the purpose of "gesture drawing" when sketching a crowd?
5. How can you draw a complex object like a house from your imagination? (Hint: simple forms).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practice:** From memory, draw a simple object from your kitchen (e.g., a kettle, a stove, a chair).
2. **Composition:** On a full A4 page, create a finished pencil drawing of an imaginative scene titled "**A Carpenter's Workshop.**"
3. *Remember to:*

- Establish a clear foreground, middle ground, and background.
- Create a focal point (e.g., the carpenter working on a piece of furniture).
- Invent a single light source and apply consistent shading to all objects (tables, tools, wood shavings).



WEEK 3: NATURE PAINTING

3.1 MEANING AND CHARACTERISTICS OF NATURE PAINTING

Nature Painting is a genre of art that focuses on painting objects from the natural world. It is distinct from:

- **Still Life:** Which focuses on man-made, inanimate objects (pots, books, etc.).
- **Landscape:** Which focuses on a wide, expansive view of scenery (mountains, rivers).

Nature painting is a more *intimate* and *close-up* study of natural forms.



Characteristics:

- **Organic Forms:** Dominated by irregular, flowing, and curved lines, rather than rigid geometric shapes.

- **Emphasis on Texture:** The artist aims to capture the specific *feel* of surfaces: the roughness of bark, the smoothness of a shell, the softness of a feather, the hard, porous surface of a skull.
- **Natural Colour Palette:** Colours are drawn from the earth: browns, greens, greys, and the vibrant colours of flowers and insects.

3.2 NATURAL OBJECTS FOR PAINTING

Artists are drawn to these objects because each one presents a unique challenge in form, colour, and texture:

- **Plants:** (Flowers, leaves, tree branches) - for studying colour and delicate forms.
- **Animals:** (Insects, birds, fish) - for studying pattern and texture.
- **Shells:** (Snail shells, seashells) - for studying spiral patterns and smooth, iridescent surfaces.
- **Skulls and Bones:** A classic subject. Artists love them because they are complex 3D forms that are excellent for studying light and shadow (*chiaroscuro*). They also have symbolic meaning (*memento mori* - a reminder of life and death).
- **Geological Forms:** (Mountains, rocks, pebbles) - for studying rough textures and solid forms.

3.3 ARRANGEMENT AND COMPONENTS OF NATURE PAINTING

A nature painting is *not* just a random collection of objects. Like any other composition, it must be *arranged*.

1. **Composition:** The artist selects and arranges the objects (e.g., a skull, two shells, and a dead flower) on a surface.
2. **Focal Point:** One object is chosen as the main subject (e.g., the skull).
3. **Balance:** The other objects are placed to balance the focal point.
4. **Rhythm/Movement:** The objects are often arranged to create a "flow" that leads the viewer's eye, such as a curved branch or a scattering of pebbles.

5. **Background:** The background is usually kept simple (a plain cloth or a blurred natural setting) to avoid distracting from the main objects.

3.4 TECHNIQUES OF COLOUR APPLICATION

The artist chooses a technique based on the texture they want to create:

- **Impasto:** Applying paint very thickly (with a brush or palette knife). This is perfect for capturing the rough, three-dimensional texture of tree bark or a rocky surface.
- **Wash / Glazing:** Applying thin, transparent layers of paint. This is ideal for capturing the delicate, translucent quality of a flower petal or an insect's wing.
- **Wet-on-Wet:** Applying paint to a wet surface, allowing colours to bleed and blend. This is excellent for creating soft, blurred backgrounds.
- **Dry Brushing:** Using a dry brush with very little paint to "scrub" the canvas. This is a great way to create the texture of dry grass, wood grain, or fur.
- **Fresco:** (As per scheme) A technique of painting on wet plaster. This is a *mural* (wall) technique and is **not** typically used for a nature painting on canvas, but it could be used to paint a *mural* of a nature scene.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between Nature Painting and Landscape Painting?
2. List three characteristics of Nature Painting.
3. Why are skulls and bones a popular subject for artists to paint?
4. Which painting technique is best for creating the rough texture of tree bark?
5. What is the "Wet-on-Wet" technique, and what is it good for?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Go outside and find three interesting natural objects (e.g., a wrinkled leaf, a small stone, a twig, a feather, a flower).
2. Arrange these objects on a piece of paper or cloth in a pleasing composition.

3. Create a detailed painting of your arrangement. Focus on capturing the unique *texture* of each object.

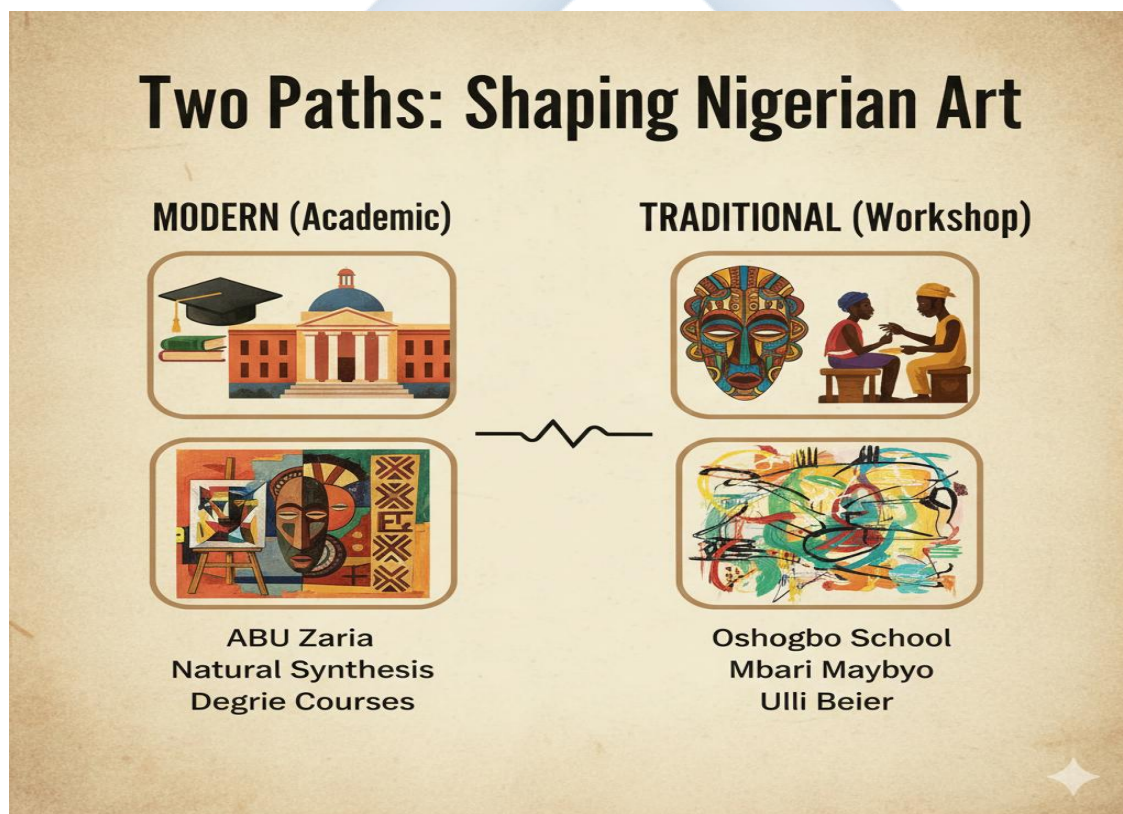


WEEK 4: MODERN AND TRADITIONAL ART INSTITUTIONS IN NIGERIA

4.1 INTRODUCTION: TWO PHILOSOPHIES OF ART EDUCATION

Nigeria has a rich and complex art scene that is fed by two distinct types of institutions:

1. **Modern (Academic) Institutions:** These are formal, European-style university departments and colleges. They offer structured courses, degrees (B.A., M.A.), and study art in an intellectual and global context.
2. **Traditional (Workshop) Institutions:** These are informal or semi-formal centres. They are based on the traditional *apprenticeship* model, where skills are passed directly from a master artist to a student. They focus on practical skills, cultural expression, and African philosophy.



4.2 MODERN ART INSTITUTIONS

- Ahmadu Bello University (ABU), Zaria:

- **History:** The most historically significant art school in Nigeria. In the late 1950s, its Nigerian students (like Bruce Onobrakpeya, Yusuf Grillo, and Demas Nwoko) formed the "Zaria Art Society."
- **Contribution:** They rejected the European-centric curriculum and developed a new philosophy called "**Natural Synthesis.**" This was the idea of *fusing* Western techniques (like oil painting, perspective) with African subject matter, aesthetics, and themes (like masquerades, folk tales, and *Uli* patterns). They essentially created *Modern Nigerian Art*.
- **Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU), Ife:**
 - **History:** Its art department is famous for its location in Ife, the ancestral home of Yoruba art (the famous Ife bronze heads).
 - **Contribution:** The "Ife School" is known for its strong focus on Yoruba art history and mythology, blending academic learning with the ancient traditions right at its doorstep.
- **Colleges of Education (e.g., Adeyemi College of Education, Ondo):**
 - **Contribution:** These institutions are critically important because their primary mission is to **train qualified art teachers** for secondary schools, ensuring the next generation is educated in art.
- **Other Universities (e.g., Olabisi Onabanjo University, UNN, Yabatech):**
 - These institutions (Universities and Polytechnics) form the backbone of the academic art world, producing graduates who become studio artists, graphic designers, art historians, and teachers.
- **Courses Offered:** B.A. or HND in Fine and Applied Arts, with specializations in Painting, Sculpture, Graphics (Graphic Design), Textiles, Ceramics, and Art History.

4.3 TRADITIONAL ART INSTITUTIONS (WORKSHOPS)

- **Mbari Mbayo Art Centre (Oshogbo):**
 - **History:** This is the most famous workshop. It was started in the early 1960s in Oshogbo by **Ulli Beier** and **Duro Ladipo**.

- **Philosophy:** It was *not* a school. It was a *workshop* and cultural club. Beier did not "teach" art; he provided materials (paints, boards) and encouragement, letting local actors, sign-writers, and other people express their innate creativity.
- **Contribution:** It produced the "Oshogbo School" of artists, who became world-famous. Their art is known for being spiritual, fantastical, and deeply rooted in Yoruba mythology. Key artists include **Twins Seven-Seven** and **Jimoh Buraimoh** (who pioneered bead painting).
- **Nri Art Centre:**
 - **History:** Located in Nri, the ancient spiritual home of the Igbo people, famous for the *Igbo-Ukwu* bronzes.
 - **Contribution:** This centre is focused on the *preservation* and *continuation* of traditional Igbo art forms, particularly *Uli* body and wall painting, carving, and metalwork. It acts as a living museum and workshop.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference in *philosophy* between a Modern art institution and a Traditional one?
2. What is "Natural Synthesis," and which university is associated with it?
3. Who were the "Zaria Rebels"? (Name one).
4. What was the *philosophy* of the Mbari Mbayo Art Centre in Oshogbo?
5. Name one famous artist from the "Oshogbo School."

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a two-column table.
2. Label one column "ABU, Zaria" and the other "Oshogbo Workshop."
3. List at least four key differences between them (e.g., key figures, philosophy, style of art, entry requirements).

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: POTTERY

6.1 MEANING AND BASIC TERMINOLOGIES

Pottery is the art and craft of making functional and decorative objects (like pots, bowls, and vases) from **clay** and then firing (heating) them to make them hard and permanent.

- **Clay:** The basic material. A special type of fine-grained soil that is *plastic* (malleable) when wet and becomes rock-hard when fired.
- **Greenware:** Unfired, bone-dry clay objects. This is their most fragile state.
- **Firing:** The process of "baking" the clay in a hot oven (kiln) or open fire. This causes a permanent chemical change.
- **Bisqueware:** Clay that has been fired *once* without a glaze. It is hard but still porous (can absorb water).
- **Glaze:** A "glassy" coating (like liquid glass) that is painted onto bisqueware.
- **Glaze Firing:** The second firing, which is hotter and melts the glaze, making the pot waterproof and decorative.



6.2 DIFFERENCES BETWEEN POTTERY AND CERAMICS

This is a common point of confusion.

- **CERAMICS:** This is the **BROAD** category. It refers to *any* object made from clay (or other inorganic, non-metallic materials) and hardened by heat. This includes pottery, bricks, tiles, porcelain, satellites, and even ceramic engine parts.
- **POTTERY:** This is a **SPECIFIC** *type* of ceramic. It refers *only* to vessels and functional wares made from clay.

Analogy: All pottery is ceramic, but not all ceramics are pottery. (Just like all apples are fruit, but not all fruit are apples).

6.3 TOOLS AND MATERIALS

- **MATERIALS:**
 - **Clay:** The primary body.
 - **Water:** To make the clay workable (plastic).
 - **Temper (or Grog):** A "filler" material (like sand, crushed shells, or fine-ground fired clay) mixed into the clay. It helps *prevent cracking* and shrinking during drying and firing.
- **TOOLS:**
 - **Potter's Wheel (Turntable):** A rotating disc used to "throw" symmetrical pots.
 - **Modeling Tools:** Small wooden or plastic tools for shaping and carving.
 - **Rib:** A flat, curved tool (wood or metal) for smoothing and shaping.
 - **Wire Cutter:** A thin wire used to cut clay from a block.
 - **Kiln:** The "oven" used for firing. (Traditional Nigerian pottery uses an "open-air pit firing").

6.4 METHODS OF POTTERY MAKING (HAND-BUILDING)

These are methods that do *not* use a potter's wheel.

1. **PINCHING:** The most basic method. You start with a ball of clay, press your thumb into the centre, and "pinch" the walls up in a circular motion to form a small pot.

2. **COILING:** This is the *most common traditional African method*.
 - You roll out long, "snake-like" coils of clay.
 - You place one coil on top of another, building the walls of the pot up in a spiral.
 - The coils are then "scored" (scratched) and "slipped" (painted with liquid clay) to join them, and then smoothed out.
3. **SLAB BUILDING:** You roll out flat sheets (slabs) of clay, cut them into shapes, and join them to build geometric forms, like boxes or tiles.

6.5 FUNCTIONS AND MARKETING OF POTTERY

- **FUNCTIONS:**
 - **Utilitarian (Functional):** For cooking (cooking pots), storing water (water coolers), storing grain, and for eating/drinking (bowls, cups).
 - **Decorative:** Vases, sculptures, and wall plaques.
 - **Ritual:** Special pots used for religious ceremonies, shrines, or burials.
- **MARKETING:** Pottery wares are sold in local markets, at roadside stands (especially in pottery-making centres like Bida or Ilorin), and in modern art galleries and tourist shops.

EVALUATION

1. What is "Greenware"?
2. What is "Glaze"?
3. Explain, in one sentence, the difference between "Pottery" and "Ceramics."
4. What is the "Coiling" method of pottery?
5. What is "Temper," and why is it added to clay?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Using modelling clay (or *Plastacine*), create a small pot using the **Pinching** method.
2. **Practical:** Now, using the same clay, create a second, larger pot using the **Coiling** method.

3. Decorate the surface of your coiled pot by pressing an object (like a pen cap or a comb) into the soft clay.



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: BOOK COVER AND JACKET DESIGN

8.1 MEANING (RECAP FROM 1ST TERM)

Book Cover Design is a specialized field of **Graphic Design**. A book cover (or jacket) serves three main purposes:

1. **Protection:** To protect the pages from damage.
2. **Information:** To provide the essential information (Title, Author, Publisher).
3. **Marketing:** To act as a "mini-poster" that *attracts* a potential reader and *communicates* the book's genre and mood (e.g., is it a horror, romance, or textbook?).

Judging a Book by Its Cover: The Anatomy of Design



8.2 DIFFERENCES BETWEEN BOOK COVER AND JACKET

- **BOOK COVER:**
 - This is the *permanent* outer layer of a **paperback book**.
 - It is printed on flexible cardstock.
 - The book's pages are glued directly to its spine.

- It has only three parts: Front Cover, Back Cover, and Spine.
- **BOOK JACKET (or DUST JACKET):**
 - This is a *removable* decorative paper sleeve that wraps around a **hardcover book**.
 - The hardcover book itself is usually plain (e.g., cloth-bound with a simple title).
 - The jacket has *five* parts: Front Cover, Back Cover, Spine, and two **Flaps** (Front and Back) that fold inside the cover.

8.3 FEATURES OF BOOK DESIGN (THE ANATOMY)

- **Front Cover:** The "face" of the book. Must have the **Title** and **Author's Name**. It features the main artwork or design.
- **Spine:** The "edge" of the book that faces out from a bookshelf. It *must* have the **Title**, **Author's Name**, and the **Publisher's Logo** (or "colophon").
- **Back Cover:** The "sales pitch."
 - **Blurb:** A short, exciting summary of the book, designed to hook the reader.
 - **Reviews/Testimonials:** (Optional) Short, positive quotes from critics or other authors.
 - **ISBN (International Standard Book Number):** A unique 13-digit code for the book.
 - **Barcode:** The scannable version of the ISBN for sales.
- **Front Flap (Jacket Only):** A continuation of the blurb; a more detailed summary of the plot. The price is also often found here.
- **Back Flap (Jacket Only):**
 - **Author Bio:** A short biography of the author.
 - **Author Photo:** (Optional) A picture of the author.
 - **Publisher's Address:** Information about the publishing company.

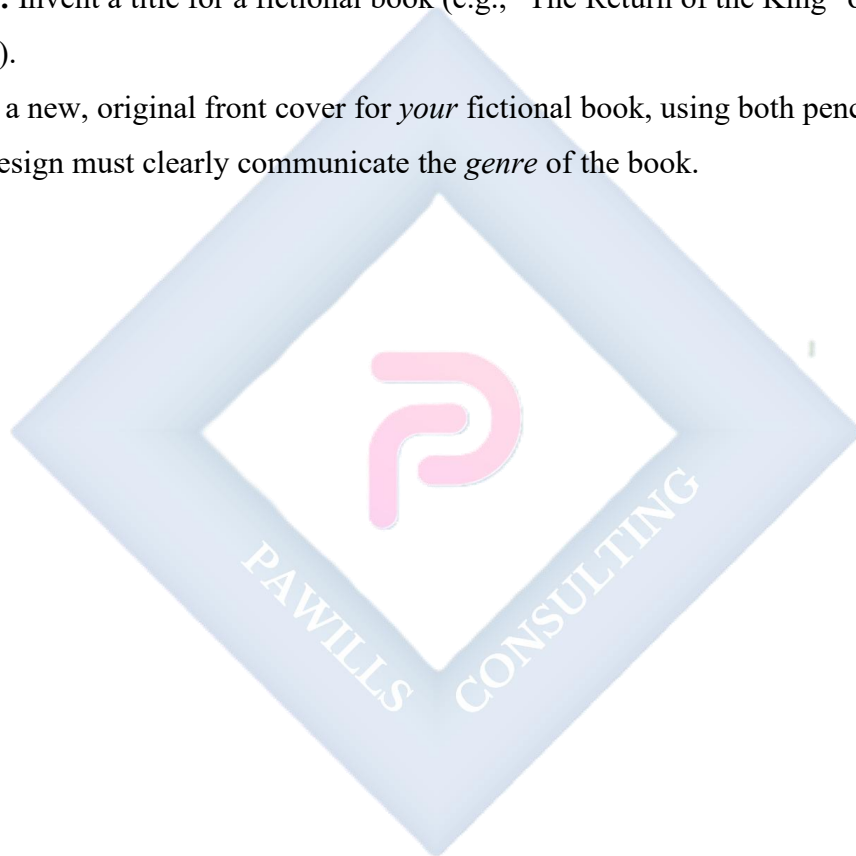
EVALUATION

1. What are the three main purposes of a book cover?
2. What is the main physical difference between a Book Cover and a Book Jacket?
3. What is a "Blurb," and where is it located?

4. What three essential pieces of information *must* be on the "Spine"?
5. What is an "Author Bio," and where is it typically found?

ASSIGNMENT

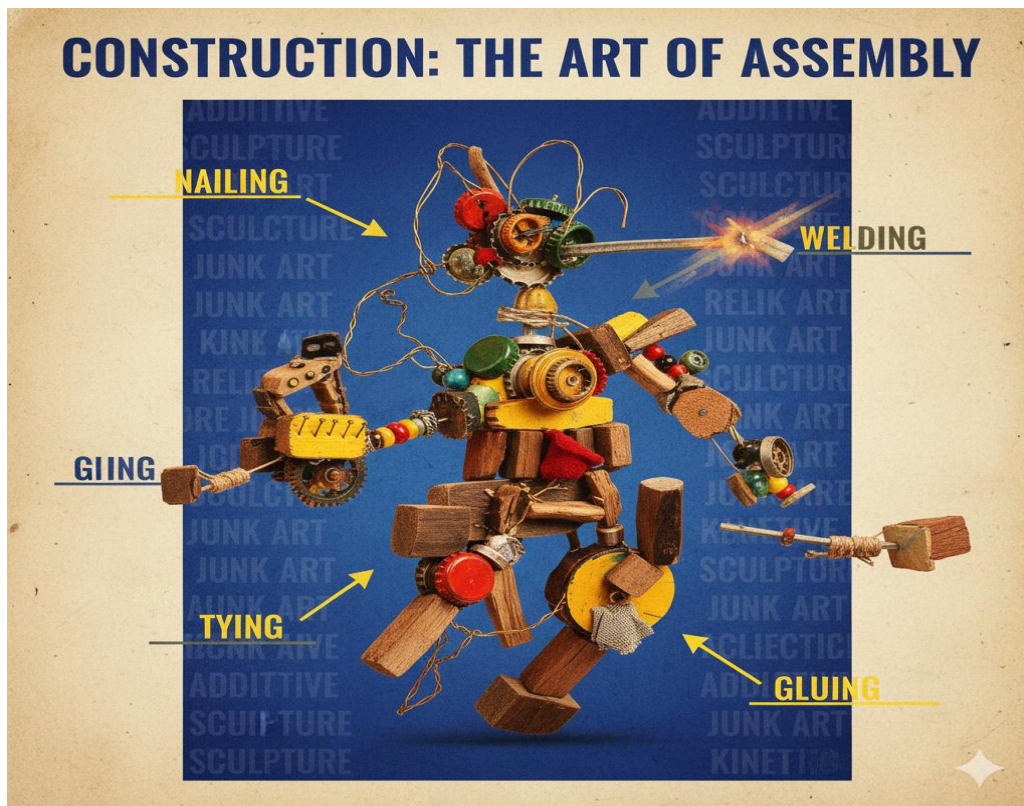
1. **Practical:** Find a book at home (a novel, textbook, etc.).
2. Draw its **front cover** as accurately as possible, paying close attention to the **typography** (the style of the letters) and the placement of the title and author.
3. **Design:** Invent a title for a fictional book (e.g., "The Return of the King" or "My Life in Lagos").
4. Design a new, original front cover for *your* fictional book, using both pencil and colour. Your design must clearly communicate the *genre* of the book.



WEEK 9: CONSTRUCTION

9.1 MEANING AND TYPES OF CONSTRUCTION IN ART

In art, **Construction** is a 3D (sculptural) technique. It is the opposite of "carving" (which is *subtractive* - taking material away). Construction is **additive**.



Definition: Construction is the art of *building* a sculpture by *assembling, joining, or attaching* various separate parts and materials.

Types of Construction:

1. **ASSEMBLAGE (JUNK ART):** This is the most famous type. The artist *finds* various non-art objects ("found objects" or "junk") and assembles them into a new artwork. (e.g., a sculpture made from old car parts, bottle caps, and wire).

2. **RELIEF CONSTRUCTION:** This is a 3D construction that is *not* free-standing. It is attached to a flat background, like a 3D collage. (e.g., gluing wood, beads, and rope onto a hardboard).
3. **KINETIC CONSTRUCTION (MOBILES):** A type of construction that is balanced and *moves* with air currents (pioneered by Alexander Calder).
4. **STRING/WIRE CONSTRUCTION:** A sculpture made primarily by stringing or weaving thread or wire, often in geometric patterns.

9.2 PROCESSES INVOLVED

1. **Concept:** Deciding what to make and what materials will best express the idea.
2. **Sourcing Materials:** Gathering the parts (wood, metal, plastic, beads, "found objects").
3. **Joining (The "How"):** This is the key process. How are the parts attached?
 - **Adhesives:** Gluing (wood glue, super glue, glue gun).
 - **Mechanical:** Nailing, screwing, bolting, riveting.
 - **Textile:** Tying (with rope/string), stitching, weaving.
 - **Metal:** Welding, soldering.
4. **Balancing:** Ensuring the final structure is physically stable and can stand on its own (if it's not a relief).
5. **Finishing:** The artist decides to either:
 - **Paint** the entire sculpture one colour to unify the different parts.
 - Leave the **raw materials** visible to show their original textures and colours.

9.3 MATERIALS USED

The beauty of construction is that *anything* can be a material:

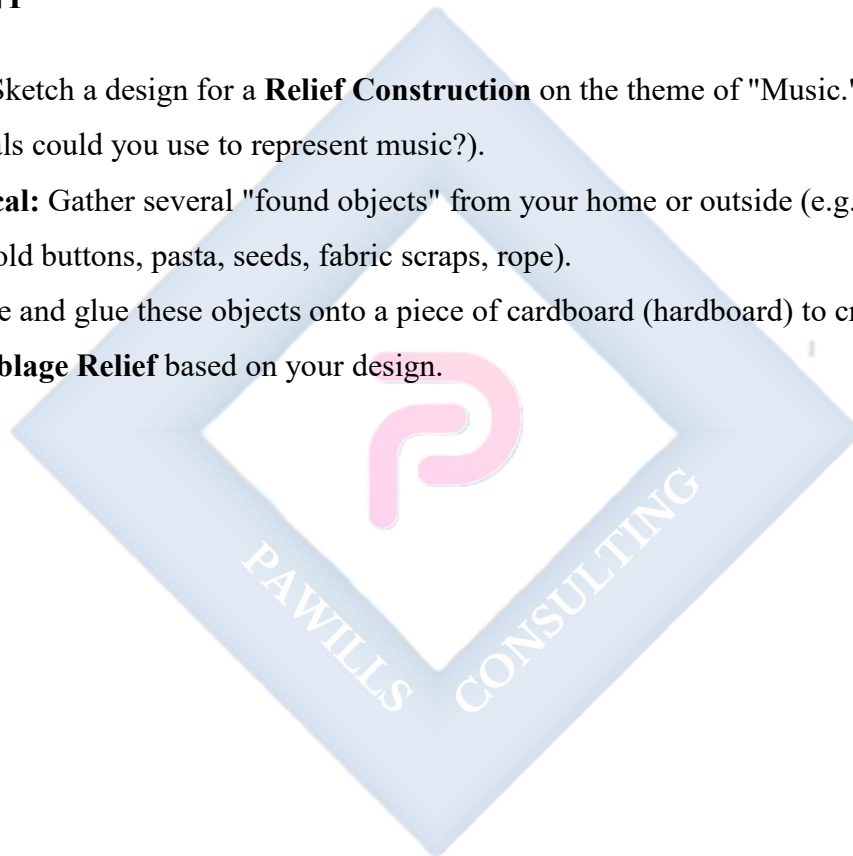
- **Hard Board / Plywood:** Often used as the flat *base* for a relief construction.
- **Beads, Rope, String, Fabric:** For texture and joining.
- **Metal:** Wire, bottle caps, cans, old car parts. (e.g., the work of **El Anatsui**, who "constructs" massive, fabric-like tapestries from thousands of bottle caps).
- **Wood:** Scraps, blocks, twigs, matches.
- **Plastic:** Bottles, old toys, containers.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "Construction" and "Carving"?
2. Define "Assemblage" (or "Junk Art").
3. What is a "Relief Construction"?
4. List three *methods* of *joining* materials in a construction.
5. Who is El Anatsui, and what "found object" is he famous for using?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Plan:** Sketch a design for a **Relief Construction** on the theme of "Music." (What "junk" materials could you use to represent music?).
2. **Practical:** Gather several "found objects" from your home or outside (e.g., bottle caps, twigs, old buttons, pasta, seeds, fabric scraps, rope).
3. Arrange and glue these objects onto a piece of cardboard (hardboard) to create an **Assemblage Relief** based on your design.



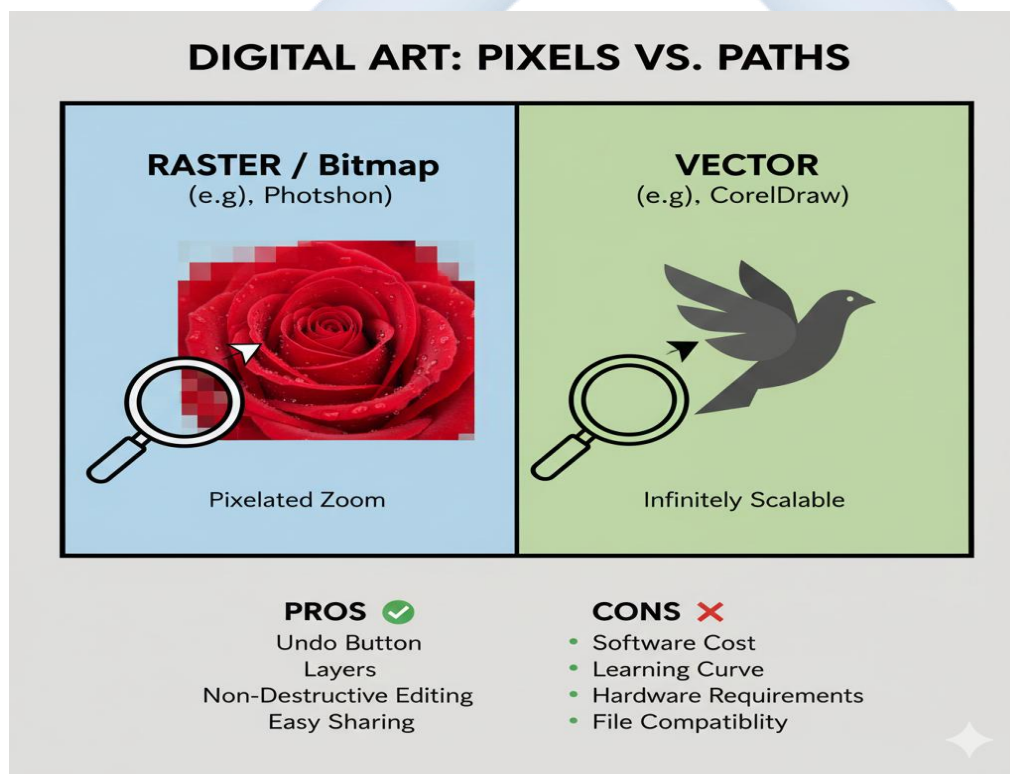
WEEK 10: COMPUTER IN VISUAL ARTS

10.1 MEANING AND TYPES OF COMPUTERS

Computer in Visual Arts (also known as **Digital Art** or **New Media**) is the use of digital technology (computers, software, and peripherals) as a *tool* to create, edit, and display art. The computer replaces the traditional canvas, brush, and pencil.

- **Types of Computers:**

- **Desktop:** A large computer (CPU tower + separate monitor) that stays in one place. Often more powerful.
- **Laptop:** A portable, all-in-one computer.
- **Tablet:** A touch-screen device (like an iPad or Wacom Cintiq) where the artist can draw directly on the screen.



10.2 PARTS, DRIVES, AND PRINTERS

- **Core Parts (Hardware):**

- **CPU (Central Processing Unit):** The "brain" of the computer.
- **Monitor:** The "screen" or display.
- **Input Devices:** Mouse, Keyboard, and (most importantly for art) the **Graphics Tablet** (a pressure-sensitive pad you draw on with a special pen, or "stylus").
- **Drives (Storage):** Where art files are saved (e.g., Hard Drive, Flash Drive, Cloud Storage).
- **Printers (Output):**
 - **Inkjet Printer:** Sprays tiny jets of ink. Best for high-quality, full-colour photo and art prints.
 - **Laser Printer:** Uses toner (powder) and heat. Best for fast, sharp text and simple graphics.

10.3 COREL DRAW: VECTOR VS. RASTER (BITMAP)

This is the most important concept in digital art.

- **RASTER (or BITMAP) Graphics (e.g., Adobe Photoshop, MS Paint):**
 - The image is made of a grid of tiny squares called **pixels**.
 - **Good for:** Photos, digital painting, complex textures.
 - **Bad for:** When you *enlarge* a Raster image, it becomes blurry and "pixelated."
- **VECTOR Graphics (e.g., CorelDraw, Adobe Illustrator):**
 - The image is *not* made of pixels. It is made of **mathematical paths** (lines, curves, and shapes).
 - **Good for:** Logos, text, cartoon illustrations, and graphic design.
 - **Bad for:** Photorealism.
 - **Key Advantage:** A Vector image can be **scaled to any size**—from a business card to a building billboard—and it will *never* lose quality or become blurry.

10.4 COREL DRAW WINDOW AND TOOLS

CorelDraw is a *Vector Graphics Editor*. When you open it, you see:

- **Toolbox:** (On the left) Contains all the main tools.

- **Property Bar:** (At the top) Shows options for the tool you have selected.
- **Colour Palette:** (On the right) For choosing colours.

Key Tools:

- **Pick Tool:** The main arrow, used to select, move, and resize objects.
- **Shape Tool:** Used to *edit* the "nodes" (points) of a vector path.
- **Bézier / Pen Tool:** The most powerful tool. Used to draw complex, precise curves and shapes one point at a time.
- **Text Tool:** For typing and formatting text.
- **Fill Tool / Eyedropper:** For adding and sampling colours.

10.5 ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES

Advantages of Computer Art:

- **The "Undo" Button:** You can erase mistakes perfectly. This encourages experimentation.
- **Speed & Efficiency:** You can work much faster (e.g., fill a large area with colour instantly).
- **Duplication:** You can copy and paste elements perfectly.
- **Global Distribution:** You can email your art to a client anywhere in the world instantly.
- **Non-destructive:** You can try 100 different colour schemes on the same drawing without "ruining" the original.

Disadvantages of Computer Art:

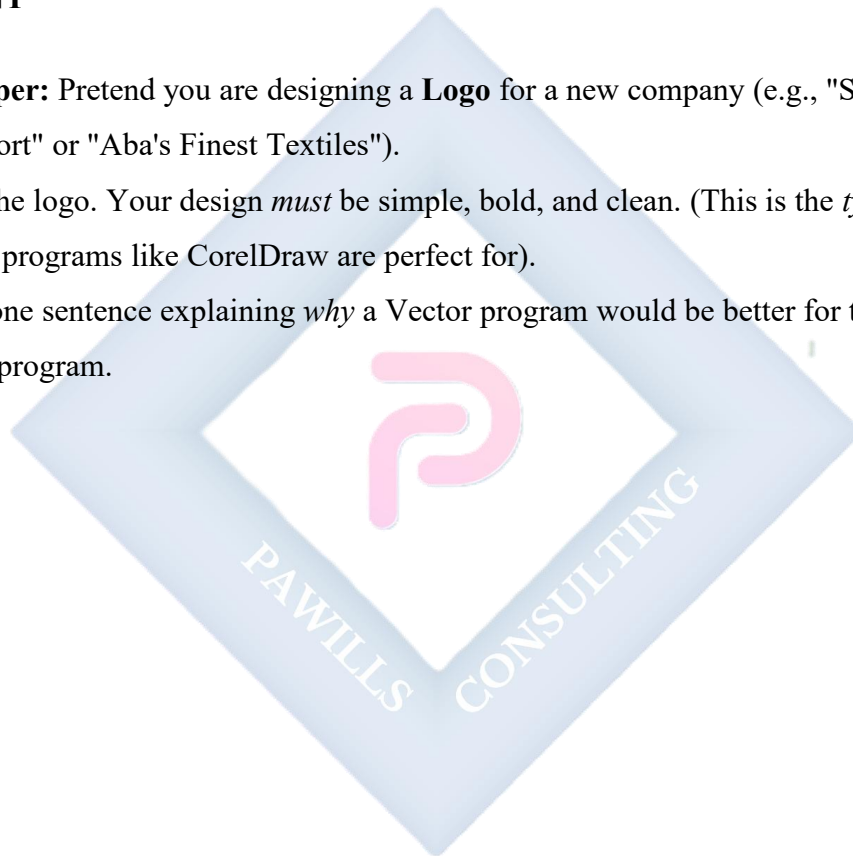
- **Cost:** Professional hardware (fast computer, graphics tablet) and software is very expensive.
- **Learning Curve:** The software is complex and can take years to master.
- **Lack of "Original":** There is no single, original, physical canvas. The art is just a file.
- **Technical Failures:** Power cuts, file corruption, or a computer crash can wipe out hours of work.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a Raster (Bitmap) image and a Vector image?
2. Is CorelDraw a Raster or Vector program?
3. What is the key advantage of a Vector image?
4. What is a "Graphics Tablet"?
5. List two major advantages and two major disadvantages of using a computer to make art.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **On Paper:** Pretend you are designing a **Logo** for a new company (e.g., "Speedy Transport" or "Aba's Finest Textiles").
2. Draw the logo. Your design *must* be simple, bold, and clean. (This is the *type* of art that Vector programs like CorelDraw are perfect for).
3. Write one sentence explaining *why* a Vector program would be better for this logo than a Raster program.



WEEK 11: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the second term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-10 in preparation for the Second Term Examination.)

- **KEY TOPICS FOR REVIEW:**

- **Imaginative Composition:** The 3 planes (Foreground, Middle Ground, Background), Focal Point, and the Rule of Thirds. How to use colour/shading to create mood/form from imagination.
- **Nature Painting:** Characteristics (texture, organic forms), and techniques (Impasto, Wash, Dry Brush).
- **Art Institutions:** The "Modern" vs. "Traditional" philosophies. "Natural Synthesis" (ABU, Zaria) vs. "Oshogbo School" (Mbari Mbayo).
- **Pottery:** Pottery vs. Ceramics, Hand-building methods (Coil, Pinch, Slab), and the firing process (Greenware, Bisqueware).
- **Book Cover Design:** Cover vs. Jacket, and the anatomy (Blurb, Spine, ISBN, Flaps, Author Bio).
- **Construction:** Additive sculpture (Assemblage, Relief), joining methods, and "found objects."
- **Computer in Art:** Raster vs. Vector (the most important concept), CorelDraw as a vector tool, and the Pros/Cons of digital art.

SS2 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

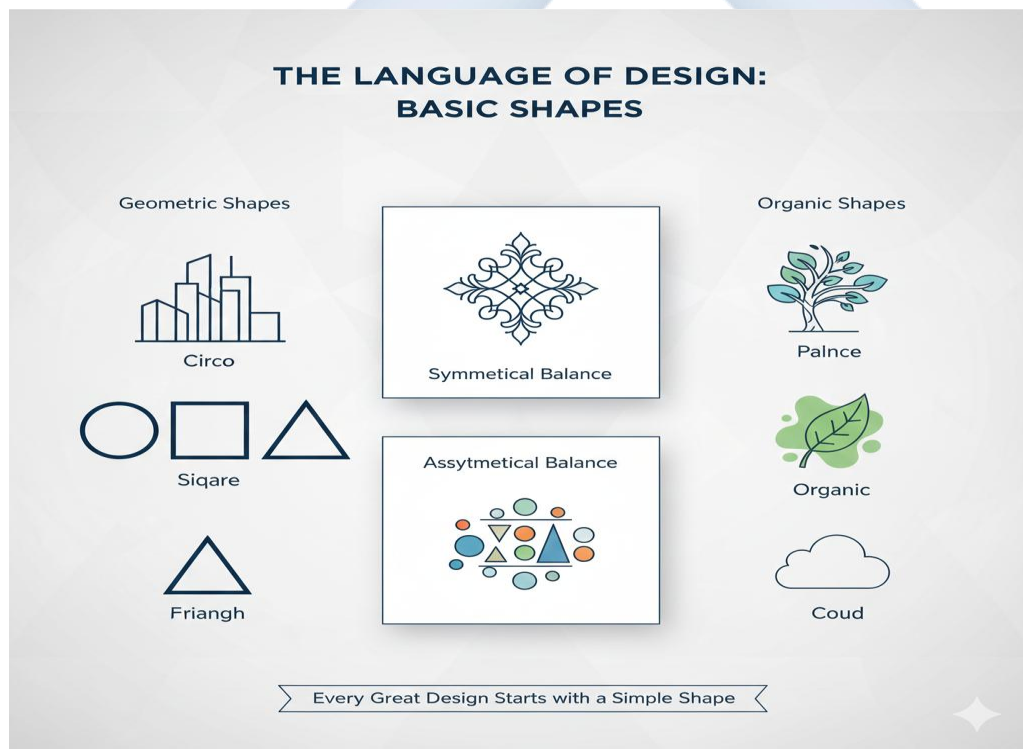
THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: BASIC SHAPES AND DESIGNS

1.1 MEANING OF BASIC SHAPES AND DESIGN

BASIC SHAPES: These are the fundamental building blocks of all visual art. A shape is a flat, enclosed area of space, defined by a line or by a boundary of colour and value.

DESIGN: Design is the *intelligent arrangement* of these basic shapes and other elements (like line, colour, texture) to create a unified and harmonious composition. Design is not just "decorating"; it is *planning* and *problem-solving* to create an effective visual message.



1.2 TYPES OF BASIC SHAPES

1. GEOMETRIC SHAPES:

- **Definition:** These are precise, mathematical, and regular shapes. They are most often man-made and can be created using tools like a ruler or compass.
- **Examples:**
 - **Circle:** A perfectly round shape.
 - **Square:** Four equal sides and four 90-degree angles.
 - **Rectangle:** Four 90-degree angles, with two opposing sides longer than the others.
 - **Triangle:** A three-sided polygon.
 - **Other Polygons:** Pentagon (5 sides), Hexagon (6 sides), Octagon (8 sides).

2. ORGANIC SHAPES (or FREE-FORM SHAPES):

- **Definition:** These shapes are irregular, fluid, and complex. They are not mathematical. They are "natural" shapes, like those found in living organisms.
- **Examples:** The shape of a leaf, a cloud, a puddle, a footprint, or an animal.

1.3 MATERIALS AND TOOLS FOR BASIC DESIGN

- **Pencils (Graphite):** For sketching ideas, drawing outlines, and shading.
- **Drawing Paper/Card:** The surface for the design.
- **Eraser:** For correcting mistakes.
- **Drawing Instruments (for geometric shapes):**
 - **Ruler/Straight-edge:** For drawing straight lines.
 - **Compass:** For drawing perfect circles and arcs.
 - **Protractor:** For measuring angles.
 - **Set Squares:** For drawing perpendicular and angled lines.
- **Colour Media:**
 - **Coloured Pencils:** For precise application of colour.
 - **Markers (Felt Pens):** For bold, flat, uniform areas of colour.
 - **Poster Colours / Watercolours:** For painting the design.

1.4 PRACTICAL APPROACH: ARRANGEMENT OF SHAPES

A good design is created by applying the **Principles of Design** to the shapes.

1. Repetition (Pattern/Rhythm):

- This is the simplest arrangement. A single shape (e.g., a circle) is repeated over and over, creating a pattern.
- *Rhythm* is created by varying the size or spacing of the repeated shapes, making the eye "move" across the page.

2. Balance: This gives the design stability.

- **Symmetrical Balance (Formal):** The design is identical on both sides of a central line (a mirror image). It feels calm, stable, and orderly.
- **Asymmetrical Balance (Informal):** The design is *not* a mirror image, but the shapes are arranged to have equal "visual weight." For example, one large shape on the left can be balanced by three small shapes on the right. It feels more dynamic and modern.

3. Contrast:

- This is used to create visual excitement and a focal point.
- You can create contrast by placing very different shapes together:
 - A large geometric shape (a square) next to a small organic shape (a leaf).
 - A complex, detailed shape next to a simple, plain shape.

4. Harmony:

- This is the overall goal. All the shapes and colours must work together to create a single, unified, and pleasing image.
- Harmony is achieved when the principles of balance, rhythm, and contrast are used correctly.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a "Geometric Shape" and an "Organic Shape"?
2. Define "Design" in the context of visual arts.
3. Name two tools used specifically for creating geometric shapes.
4. Explain the difference between Symmetrical and Asymmetrical balance.
5. How can an artist create "Contrast" using only shapes?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a 6x6 inch square on your paper.
2. Create a **Symmetrical Design** inside the square using *only* geometric shapes (circles, triangles, rectangles).
3. Draw another 6x6 inch square.
4. Create an **Asymmetrical Design** inside this square that uses *both* geometric and organic shapes.
5. Apply at least three colours to your asymmetrical design.



WEEK 2: INDIGENOUS DECORATIVE MOTIFS

2.1 MEANING OF MOTIFS

A **Motif** is a single, distinct, and recurring design element or unit that is repeated to create a larger **Pattern**. A motif is the "building block" of a pattern.

An **Indigenous Motif** is a motif that is native to a specific culture or region. In Nigeria, these motifs are often symbolic and have deep cultural meanings. They are drawn from the environment, religion, and daily life.



2.2 INDIGENOUS DECORATIVE MOTIFS (EXAMPLES)

1. FLORAL (PLANT-BASED):

- Inspired by leaves, flowers, vines, and seeds.
- Very common in **Uli** (Igbo) designs, representing new life, growth, or specific medicinal plants.

- *Example:* The *isi-nwo-ji* (yam head) motif, symbolizing prosperity.

2. ANIMAL (ZOOMORPHIC):

- Inspired by animals, reptiles, and insects.
- *Examples:*
 - **Lizard/Gecko:** Symbol of regeneration, peace, and domestic life.
 - **Snake (Python):** A very powerful symbol of royalty, power, and divinity (e.g., in *Uli* and Benin art).
 - **Tortoise:** Symbol of cunning, wisdom, and trickery.
 - **Fish:** Symbol of fertility and abundance.

3. OBJECTS (MAN-MADE / ANTHROPOMORPHIC):

- Inspired by items of daily life, tools, or human figures.
- *Examples:*
 - **Comb:** Symbol of beauty and femininity.
 - **Sango's Double-Axe (*Oshe Sango*):** Symbol of the Yoruba thunder god.
 - **Moon (Crescent):** Symbol of time, femininity, and new beginnings.
 - **Spirals/Lines:** Representing the journey of life, water, or smoke.

4. GEOMETRIC:

- Inspired by mathematical patterns.
- Very common in Northern Nigerian art (e.g., the complex "Arewa knot" or "Dagi") and on *Adire* cloth.

2.3 FORMATS FOR MOTIF MAKING (REPEAT PATTERNS)

This is *how* the single motif is arranged to create a full textile or design.

1. SIMPLE REPEAT (BLOCK / FULL DROP):

- The simplest pattern. The motif is placed in a simple grid, one after the other in straight rows and columns.
- It's predictable and stable.

2. HALF-DROP REPEAT:

- Each row is shifted *halfway down* from the row above it.

- This breaks up the rigid grid and creates a more flowing, diagonal pattern. It's more sophisticated.

3. MIRROR REPEAT:

- The motif is reflected as if in a mirror, either horizontally, vertically, or both.
- This creates a perfect symmetrical unit.

4. DIAMOND REPEAT:

- The motif is placed at the intersection points of a diamond-shaped grid.
- This is very common in traditional weaving and basketry.

EVALUATION

1. What is the difference between a "Motif" and a "Pattern"?
2. Name and draw two examples of indigenous *zoomorphic* (animal) motifs.
3. What does the python often symbolize in Nigerian art?
4. What is a "Half-Drop Repeat"? Draw a simple diagram to explain it.
5. What is the "Arewa knot"?

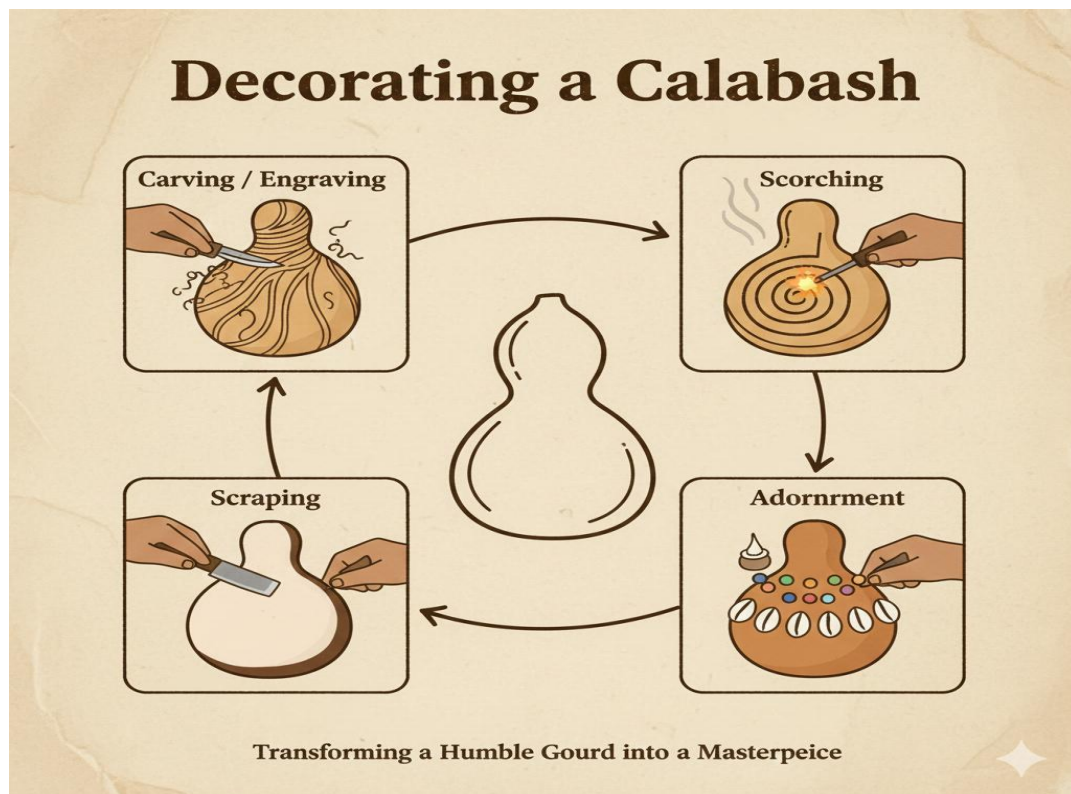
ASSIGNMENT

1. **Create:** Design one original **Indigenous Motif** based on a plant or animal from your local environment.
2. **Draw:** On an A4 paper, draw a 4x4 grid (16 squares).
3. **Repeat:** Draw your motif 16 times in a **Simple Repeat (Block)** format to fill the grid.
4. **Colour:** Apply at least two colours to your finished pattern.

WEEK 3: CALABASH DECORATION I

3.1 MEANING AND TYPES OF CALABASH

Meaning: A **Calabash** (also known as a *gourd* or *Igba*) is the dried, hard-shelled fruit of a vine-like plant. When dried, its hard, woody skin and hollow interior make it one of the most versatile and important domestic and cultural objects in traditional African society.



Types: The plant produces many varieties, which are cultivated for their specific shapes.

- **Large Round Bowls:** Used for serving food, as containers for items, or as resonators for musical instruments (e.g., *goge* - a one-stringed fiddle).
- **Bottle/Flask-shaped:** Used for carrying water or palm wine.
- **Long-Handled Scoops/Ladles:** Used as spoons, scoops, or funnels.
- **Small, Flat, or Lidded:** Used as containers for cosmetics, medicines, or jewellery.
- **Shekere:** A large, web-like calabash covered in a net of beads or cowries, used as a rattle.

3.2 TYPES OF CALABASH DECORATION (TECHNIQUES)

Calabash decoration is a highly developed art form, particularly in places like Oyo, Adamawa, and Borno.

1. CARVING / ENGRAVING:

- Using a sharp knife or pointed tool to *incise* or *cut* lines and shapes *into* the dark, hard skin of the calabash. This is a very common technique.

2. SCRAPING (POSITIVE/NEGATIVE):

- The artist *scrapes away* the dark outer skin to reveal the lighter-coloured inner shell.
- This is often used to create powerful two-colour (light and dark) designs. The unscraped part forms the (dark) design, or the scraped part forms the (light) design.

3. SCORCHING / PYROGRAPHY:

- Using a heated piece of metal (like a knife, nail, or flattened rod) to *burn* designs onto the surface.
- This creates rich, dark-brown or black lines and shapes that contrast with the light-brown calabash.

4. PAINTING:

- Applying pigments (traditional chalks and dyes, or modern paints) to the surface. This is less common traditionally but is now popular for tourist items.

5. ADORNMENT / APPLIQUÉ:

- Decorating the calabash by *attaching* other materials to it, such as cowries, beads, coins, seeds, or small pieces of metal.

3.3 USES AND FUNCTIONS OF DECORATED CALABASH

1. **Domestic Use:** As beautiful and high-status bowls for serving food (especially to guests), cups for drinking, and containers for storage.
2. **Ritual/Spiritual Use:** As important objects in shrines, divination bowls (*agere Ifa*), or containers for holding sacred materials.

3. **Musical Instruments:** As the body of a *kora* (harp), *goge* (fiddle), or the full *shekere*.
4. **Social Status:** A beautifully decorated calabash, especially one with cowries, can signify wealth and prestige.
5. **Commercial/Decorative:** Sold as works of art or tourist souvenirs.

3.4 MARKETING AND OUTLETS

- **Local Markets:** The primary outlet, where they are sold for domestic use.
- **Tourist/Craft Centres:** (e.g., in Abuja, Lagos, or calabash-producing towns like Oyo) where they are sold as souvenirs.
- **Art Galleries:** High-quality, artistic calabashes are sold in fine art galleries as sculptures.
- **Export:** Shipped and sold internationally.

EVALUATION

1. What is a calabash?
2. Explain the difference between "Engraving" and "Scorching" as decoration techniques.
3. What is the "Scraping" technique, and what kind of visual effect does it create?
4. List three non-domestic (i.e., ritual or musical) uses for a calabash.
5. What is a "Shekere"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Research the calabash decoration styles of either **Oyo (Yoruba)** or **Adamawa/Borno (Fulani)**.
2. Write one paragraph describing their unique style. (e.g., Are they known for carving? Scorching? What kinds of patterns do they use?).
3. On paper, design a pattern that would be suitable for decorating a large, round calabash bowl, using motifs from Week 2.

WEEK 4: CALABASH DECORATION II (PRACTICAL)

4.1 PRACTICAL DECORATION OF CALABASH

This lesson focuses on the practical *application* of the techniques learned in Week 3. While a real calabash is ideal, these techniques can be simulated on paper or other objects.

Simulated Practical Steps:

1. **SELECT A SURFACE:** (A real calabash, a coconut shell, a plastic bowl, or a large circle drawn on brown paper).
2. **PREPARE THE SURFACE:** The surface must be clean and dry.
3. **TRANSFER THE DESIGN:** Draw your chosen indigenous motifs (from Week 2) onto the surface using a soft pencil.
4. **APPLY THE DECORATION (SIMULATED):**
 - **To simulate ENGRAVING:** Use a ballpoint pen or a sharp, hard pencil (like a 2H) to press *hard* and create deep, incised lines.
 - **To simulate SCORCHING:** Use a dark brown or black marker to carefully draw the design, creating the "burned" effect.
 - **To simulate PAINTING:** Use poster colours or acrylic paints to fill in areas of the design.
 - **To simulate ADORNMENT:** Use glue to attach small objects (beads, cowries, coins, seeds, or even pasta) to the surface.

4.2 INFLUENCE OF FOREIGN CULTURES ON CALABASH DECORATION

Traditional calabash art has been changed by contact with other cultures (e.g., European, Arabic).

- **New Motifs:**
 - **Writing (Calligraphy):** The introduction of Arabic script (in the North) and Roman letters (in the South). Decorators now add names, dates, or greetings.

- **Figurative Images:** The influence of photography and European art has led to attempts to carve or burn realistic images of people, cars, or coats of arms, which were not traditional.
- **New Materials:**
 - **Gloss Varnish:** The use of modern, high-gloss industrial varnish to make the calabash shiny, which is very popular in the tourist market.
 - **Glitter/Plastic:** Use of plastic beads instead of seeds, and glitter for sparkle.
- **New Forms/Uses:**
 - Creating new objects specifically for foreigners, such as lamp shades, handbags, or non-functional "art for art's sake" pieces.

4.3 VALUE AND RELEVANCE OF CALABASH DECORATION

1. **Cultural Preservation:** It is a living art form that preserves and passes down traditional motifs, symbols, and stories.
2. **Economic Value:** It provides a significant source of income for craftspeople and artists, especially in rural areas. It is a key part of Nigeria's craft and tourism economy.
3. **Aesthetic Value:** It is a unique and beautiful form of natural art, appreciated by collectors worldwide.
4. **Functional:** It continues to be a useful, sustainable, and biodegradable alternative to plastic bowls and containers in many homes.

EVALUATION

1. Describe how you would *simulate* the "scorching" technique on paper.
2. List two ways foreign cultures have influenced calabash decoration.
3. What is "gloss varnish," and why is it used?
4. State two reasons why calabash decoration is still relevant and valuable today.
5. What new *forms* (objects) are now being made from calabashes?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Find a small, smooth, rounded object (a plastic bowl, a coconut shell, a large mango seed, or even just a smooth stone).
2. Using a permanent marker or paint, decorate the *entire* object with a pattern of indigenous motifs.
3. Try to combine at least two "techniques" (e.g., draw some lines with a black marker to *simulate scorching* and glue on some beads or seeds for *adornment*).



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

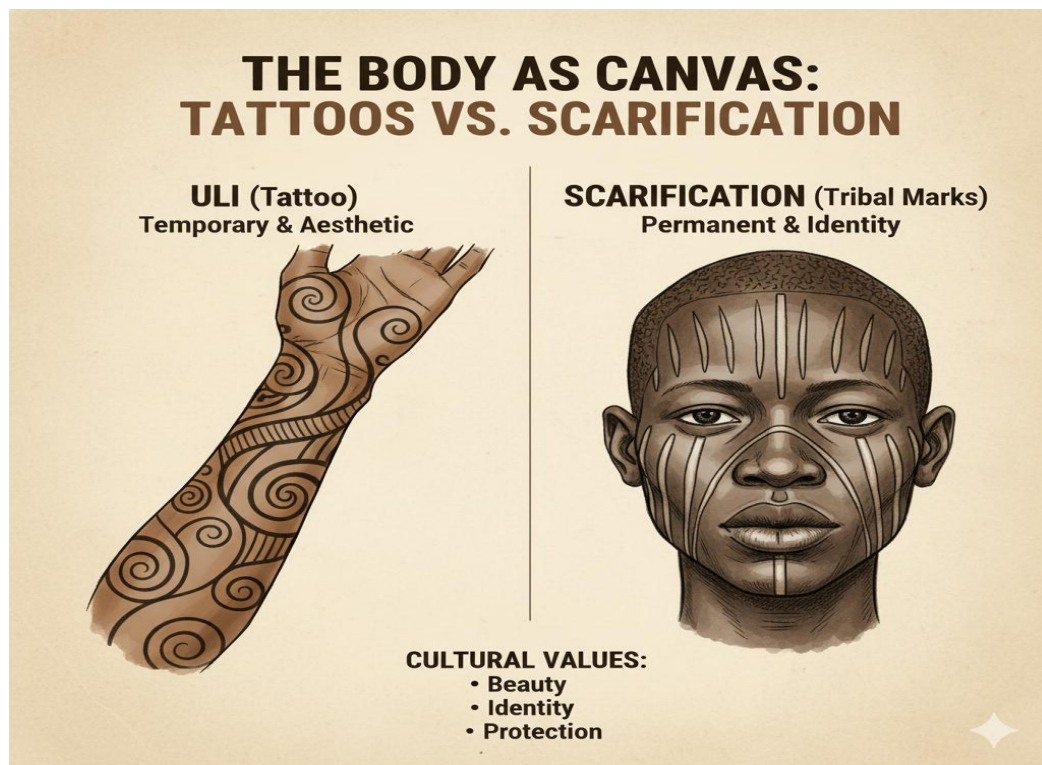
(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: INDIGENOUS MOTIFS (BODY DECORATION – TATTOOS)

6.1 MEANING OF BODY DECORATION

Body Decoration (or Body Adornment/Modification) is the universal human practice of altering or decorating the body for aesthetic, social, or spiritual reasons. It is a form of communication, using the body as a "canvas" to send messages about identity.



6.2 ORIGIN AND IMPORTANCE OF TATTOOS & SCARIFICATION

In Nigeria, traditional body marking falls into two main categories:

1. Tattooing (*Uli*):

- **Process:** Inserting a pigment *under* the skin. The most famous example is **Uli**, practiced by Igbo women.
- **Tools:** A sharp thorn or small knife (for light cuts) and a dark pigment made from *Uli* plant juice.

- **Nature:** This form of tattooing was *temporary*. The dark patterns lasted for a few weeks and were reapplied for special occasions (like marriage or festivals).
- **Importance:** Purely for *beautification* and *aesthetic* appeal.

2. Scarification (Tribal Marks):

- **Process:** This is the more common *permanent* indigenous marking. It involves *cutting* the skin with a sharp blade in a specific pattern and (sometimes) rubbing ash or pigment into the wound to create a raised, permanent **scar**.
- **Importance (Cultural Values):**
 - **Identity:** This was the *primary* function. Marks on the face (e.g., Yoruba tribal marks) were like a "passport" that identified a person's family, lineage, town, and ethnic group.
 - **Status:** Specific marks could show that a person was a noble, a chief, or had gone through an initiation.
 - **Spiritual Protection:** Some marks (*gbebe*) were believed to protect against evil spirits or illness.
 - **Beautification:** In many cultures, a woman with fine, intricate scarification patterns on her torso was considered extremely beautiful and desirable.

6.3 TOOLS AND MOTIFS USED

- **Tools:**
 - For Tattoos (*Uli*): Thorns, sharp metal points, *Uli* juice/pigment.
 - For Scarification: Special sharp knives, razors, herbal mixtures.
- **Types of Motifs/Designs:**
 - **Lines:** The most common element. Straight, parallel lines (like on the face) or curved lines.
 - **Geometric:** Patterns of dots, squares, or chevrons (common on the torso).
 - **Spiral:** A common *Uli* motif, representing the flow of life.
 - **Zoomorphic:** Stylized animals, especially the lizard or snake, often seen in *Uli*.
 - (*The prompt's "animation" is likely a mistranslation of "animate" or "figurative," referring to human or animal forms*).

6.4 CULTURAL VALUES AND DECLINE

The cultural value of these marks was immense: they were a person's biography written on their skin. However, the practice declined sharply due to:

- **Colonialism & Religion:** Missionaries and colonial officials viewed the practice as "uncivilized" and discouraged it.
- **Urbanization:** As people moved to cities, their "village identity" became less important, and marks made them targets of discrimination.
- **Modernization:** Today, the practice is very rare and is being replaced by modern, Western-style tattooing (using electric needles) which has different meanings.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "Tattooing" (like *Uli*) and "Scarification"?
2. What was the *primary* function of facial scarification (tribal marks)?
3. Name two tools used for traditional body modification.
4. Why was *Uli* tattooing considered temporary?
5. List two reasons why the practice of scarification declined in Nigeria.

ASSIGNMENT

1. The art of *Uli* is known for its beautiful, flowing, organic motifs.
2. Research "Igbo Uli Motifs" online or in a textbook.
3. On a sheet of paper, draw a large outline of a hand and an arm.
4. Fill the arm with an intricate design inspired by *Uli* patterns (spirals, lines, dots, and zoomorphic shapes).

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)

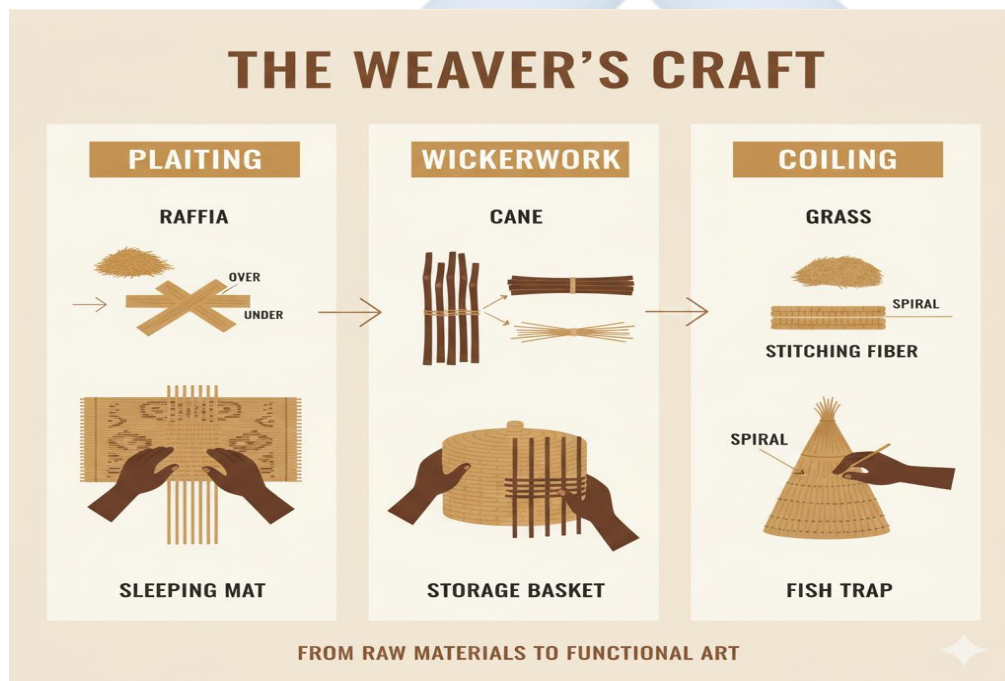


WEEK 8: INDIGENOUS MOTIFS (MURAL DESIGNS)

8.1 MEANING AND ORIGIN OF MURAL DESIGN

A **Mural** is any large-scale painting or design applied *directly to a wall, ceiling, or other large, permanent surface*. It is one of the oldest and most communal art forms, found in caves, palaces, tombs, and public buildings across the world.

Origin: In Nigeria, indigenous murals were a major art form, traditionally practiced *by women*. They were not permanent (like European frescos) but were *ephemeral*—they were painted for a specific festival or season and would be washed away by the rains, only to be repainted (and redesigned) the next year.



8.2 EXAMPLES OF INDIGENOUS MURAL DESIGNS

1. IGBO (*ULI*) MURALS:

- **Location:** Painted on the mud walls of family compounds and shrines (e.g., shrines for the *Ala* - the earth goddess).

- **Motifs:** The same as in body painting. Flowing, linear, and symbolic. They are not meant to "fill" the whole wall but are placed in specific, balanced patterns on the plain mud background.
- **Key Motifs:** *Agwọ* (Python), *Onwa* (Moon), *Eke* (Lizard), and various abstract spirals and lines.
- **Style:** Very elegant, minimalist, and based on lines (linear).

2. YORUBA MURALS:

- **Location:** Found on the walls of shrines for the *Orisha* (gods) or on palace walls.
- **Motifs:** Often more figurative than *Uli*. They may depict the *Orisha* themselves or their symbols.
- **Examples:** The **Sango Wand (*Oshe Sango*)**, fish, birds, and snakes. They are often low-relief (slightly sculpted from the mud) as well as painted.

3. HAUSA (NORTHERN) MURALS:

- **Location:** On the grand, exterior facades (fronts) of Emirs' palaces (e.g., Zaria) and wealthy homes.
- **Motifs:** Strictly non-figurative due to Islamic tradition. They are highly complex, bold, and **geometric**.
- **Examples:** Interlocking patterns, triangles, diamonds, and the "Arewa knot." They are often brightly painted in many colours.

8.3 MATERIALS AND TOOLS FOR MURAL ART

• TRADITIONAL MATERIALS:

- **Surface:** The smooth mud or clay-plastered wall itself.
- **Pigments (Colours):** All sourced from the earth.
 - **White:** *Efun* (chalk) or kaolin clay.
 - **Red/Yellow:** *Ocher* (coloured clays).
 - **Black:** Charcoal or soot.
 - **Blue:** (Rare) from indigo dye.
- **Tools:** The artist's *fingers*, brushes made from frayed twigs, feathers, or bundles of grass.

• MODERN MATERIALS:

- **Surface:** Cement (plaster) walls.
- **Pigments:** Commercial emulsion (house) paint, acrylic paint, or spray paint.
- **Tools:** Modern synthetic paintbrushes, rollers, stencils, and spray guns.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "Mural"?
2. What does it mean to say that traditional Nigerian murals were "ephemeral"?
3. Compare the *style* of Igbo *Uli* murals with traditional Hausa murals.
4. List the four traditional pigments (colours) and where they came from.
5. What modern materials are now used for mural painting?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Divide an A4 paper into two sections.
2. **Section 1:** Design a small mural in the **Uli style** (linear, organic, lots of open space).
3. **Section 2:** Design a small mural in the **Hausa style** (geometric, bold, interlocking patterns, fill the space).
4. You may use colour or just a black pen/marker.

WEEK 9: INDIGENOUS CRAFT MAKING (BASKETS AND MATS)

9.1 MEANING OF BASKET AND MAT WEAVING (BASKETRY)

Basketry is the indigenous craft of weaving or stitching flexible materials (like grass, reed, or palm fronds) to create containers (baskets) or flat surfaces (mats). It is one of the oldest and most widespread crafts in the world, as it requires only simple tools and readily available materials.



9.2 PLACES KNOWN FOR WEAVING

While basketry is practiced in almost every rural community in Nigeria, some areas are famous for their specific styles:

- **Ikot Ekpene (Akwa Ibom):** Often called the "Basketry capital of Nigeria," famous for its intricate work with raffia and cane.
- **Bida (Niger State):** Known for a wide variety of crafts, including colourful, patterned baskets.

- **Kano & Northern States:** Famous for coiled baskets and large, flat circular mats made of dyed grasses.
- **Badagry (Lagos):** Known for its strong coconut and palm-fibre mats.

9.3 MATERIALS AND TOOLS

- **MATERIALS:**
 - **Raffia Palm:** The most important material. The fronds and fibres are used.
 - **Cane:** Strong, flexible woody stems used for the "skeleton" or frame of baskets.
 - **Grasses:** Various local grasses, which are dried and sometimes dyed.
 - **Palm Fronds:** Split and used for heavy-duty mats and baskets.
 - **Dyes:** Natural (from barks, seeds) or synthetic (commercial) dyes for colour.
- **TOOLS:** Very simple.
 - **Knife or Cutlass:** To harvest and split the materials.
 - **Awl or Spike:** A pointed tool (metal or wood) used to pierce holes (in the coiling technique).
 - **Needle:** A large needle for stitching coiled baskets.

9.4 BASIC WEAVING TECHNIQUES

1. **PLAITING:** The simplest method, often used for mats. Wide, flat strips (like palm fronds) are interlaced at right angles (one over, one under) or braided together.
2. **WICKERWORK:** The "classic" basket weave. A strong, rigid frame of "stakes" (like cane) is set up, and a flexible weaver is woven in and out of the stakes.
3. **COILING:** A very common African technique. A "core" or "foundation" (like a bundle of grass) is coiled in a spiral, and each new coil is *stitched* to the one below it using a thinner, flexible strand.

9.5 PRODUCTS, FUNCTIONS, AND USES

- **MATS:**
 - *Functions:* For sleeping, sitting, praying, drying food (cassava, peppers), covering walls, and for burial.

- **BASKETS:**

- *Functions:*

- **Storage:** Storing food, grains, or clothing.
 - **Carrying:** Carrying goods to/from the farm or market.
 - **Processing:** *Sieves* (for *garri* or *fufu*), *fish traps*.
 - **Domestic:** Laundry baskets, wastepaper baskets.

EVALUATION

1. What is "Basketry"?
2. Which Nigerian town is famously known as the "Basketry Capital"?
3. List three common materials used in mat and basket weaving.
4. Explain the "Coiling" technique.
5. List three different functions of baskets (not just "storage").

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** You can simulate weaving using paper.
2. Cut an A5 piece of paper (the "loom"). Fold it in half and cut parallel lines (the "warp"), stopping 1 inch from the edge.
3. Cut several long strips of *different coloured* paper (the "weft").
4. Weave the "weft" strips over and under the "warp" strips to create a simple, flat "paper mat."

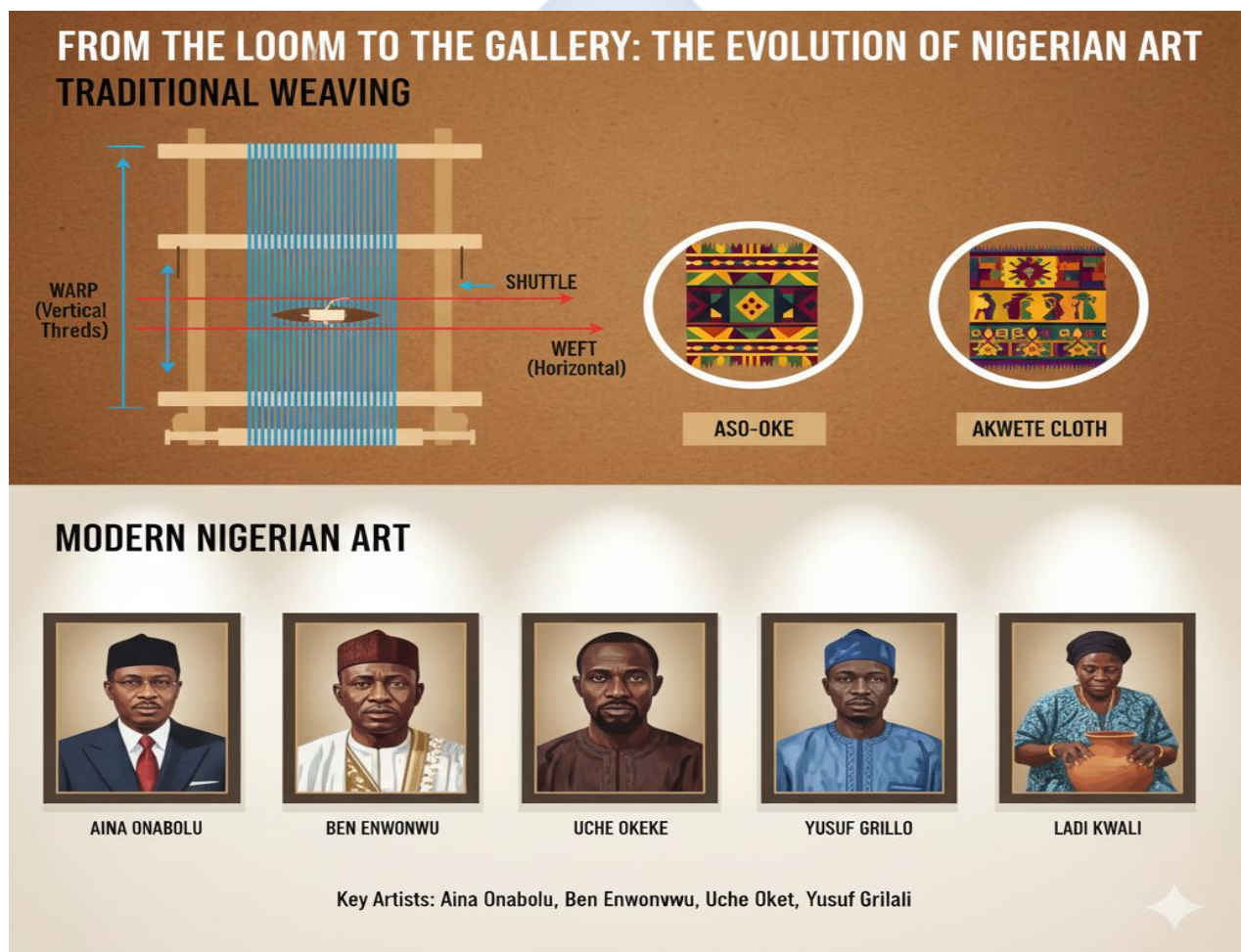
WEEK 10: CLOTH WEAVING & MODERN NIGERIAN ART

(This is a two-part lesson)

PART A: INDIGENOUS CRAFT (CLOTH WEAVING)

10.1 MEANING AND PRINCIPLES OF WEAVING

Cloth Weaving is the traditional craft of creating fabric by interlacing two separate sets of threads at right angles.



The Principles/Tools:

1. **The LOOM:** The machine used to hold the threads.

- **Horizontal Loom:** Used by men (e.t., for *Aso-Ofi*). It produces a long, *narrow* strip of cloth (about 4-6 inches wide), which is later cut and sewn together.
 - **Vertical Loom:** Used by women (e.g., for *Akwete*). It is a stationary frame that produces a single, *wide* panel of cloth.
2. **WARP:** The set of vertical threads that are held taut (under tension) on the loom. This is the "skeleton" of the fabric.
 3. **WEFT:** The set of horizontal threads that are passed *over and under* the warp threads. This is the thread that builds up the cloth.
 4. **SHUTTLE:** A small, boat-shaped tool that holds the *weft* thread and allows the weaver to pass it quickly from one side of the loom to the other.

10.2 MATERIALS AND PROMINENT TOWNS

- **Materials:** Traditionally **cotton** and **silk** (imported). Today, **synthetic threads** (rayon, polyester) are widely used for their bright colours and durability.
- **Prominent Weaving Towns:**
 - **Iseyin & Oyo (Oyo State):** The home of Yoruba **Aso-Ofi** (also called *Aso-Oke*), woven on horizontal looms.
 - **Akwete (Abia State):** Famous for its intricate, wide-panel cloth woven by women on vertical looms.
 - **Okene (Kogi State):** Known for its unique, richly coloured and patterned cloths.
 - **Kano:** A historical centre for cotton cultivation and weaving.
- **Functions:** Woven cloths are not for everyday use. They are "prestige" items used for special occasions: weddings, funerals, chieftaincy ceremonies, and as royal regalia.

PART B: MODERN NIGERIAN ART AND ARTISTS

10.3 MEANING AND ORIGIN

Modern (Contemporary) Nigerian Art is art from the 20th century to the present. It is defined by the *synthesis* (blending) of traditional Nigerian themes, motifs, and aesthetics with Western techniques (like oil painting on canvas, perspective, and modern sculpture). It moved art from a

"functional craft" (e.g., making a pot for water) to "art for art's sake" (e.g., making a pot as a beautiful sculpture).

10.4 FORMS OF MODERN ART

- **Sculpture:** Using modern materials (cement, metal, bronze) and traditional (wood) in new, expressive ways.
- **Ceramics:** Studio pottery, where pots are made as art, not just for function.
- **Textiles:** Using cloth for "wall hangings" (tapestries) instead of just for clothing.
- **Graphics:** Graphic design, printmaking, and digital art.
- **Painting:** The most dominant form, using oil, acrylic, or watercolour on canvas.

10.5 NOTABLE NIGERIAN STUDIO ARTISTS AND EDUCATORS

- **THE PIONEERS (Pre-Independence):**
 - **Aina Onabolu (1882-1963):** The "Father of Modern Nigerian Art." He was a self-taught artist who went to Europe to master *realism*. His goal was to prove that Africans could create Western art just as well as Europeans, and he fought to have art taught in Nigerian schools.
 - **Akinola Lasekan (1916-1972):** A second pioneer, also known for his realistic paintings, but more famous as a *political cartoonist* for the *West African Pilot*, using his art to fight for independence.
- **THE "NATURAL SYNTHESIS" GROUP (The "Zaria Rebels"):**
 - **Ben Enwonwu (1917-1994):** The first Nigerian artist to become internationally famous. A brilliant painter and sculptor who blended traditional themes with a modern, expressive style. (Famous for his sculpture *Tutu*).
 - **Uche Okeke (1933-2016):** A leader of the Zaria Art Society. He championed "Natural Synthesis" and based his work on *Uli* designs, co-founding the "Nsukka School" of art.
 - **Yusuf Grillo (1934-2021):** A Zaria Rebel famous for his elegant, elongated paintings. His work often features Yoruba themes and a characteristic blue/purple colour palette.

- **MASTER CRAFT ARTISTS & EDUCATORS:**

- **Ladi Kwali (1925-1984):** A Gwari "traditional" potter who was so brilliant she was brought to the Abuja Pottery Training Centre. She became a "studio potter," blending her traditional coiling/decorating skills with modern ceramics (glazing, wheel-throwing). She became world-famous, proving the genius of traditional craft.
- **Kolade Oshinowo (b. 1948):** A highly influential contemporary painter and art educator (at Yaba College of Technology). He is known for his large, textured, and expressive canvases that often depict crowds and social themes.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a horizontal loom and a vertical loom?
2. Define "Warp" and "Weft."
3. What is "Natural Synthesis"?
4. What was Aina Onabolu's primary contribution to Nigerian art?
5. Who was Ladi Kwali, and why is she so important in the history of Nigerian art?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose **one** of the Modern Nigerian Artists listed (e.g., Ben Enwonwu, Yusuf Grillo, Ladi Kwali).
2. Do a 10-minute research on their work.
3. Write one paragraph describing their unique style.
4. On paper, try to create a *small, simple* drawing "in the style of" that artist (e.g., a "blue" painting for Grillo, a pot with indigenous patterns for Kwali, a realistic portrait for Onabolu).

WEEK 11: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the third term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-10 in preparation for the Third Term Examination.)

• KEY CONCEPTS FOR REVIEW:

- **Design:** Geometric vs. Organic Shapes, Symmetrical vs. Asymmetrical Balance, Principles of Design.
- **Motifs & Patterns:** Motif vs. Pattern, Types of Indigenous Motifs (Zoomorphic, Floral, etc.), Repeat Formats (Half-drop, Simple, Mirror).
- **Calabash:** Decoration Techniques (Carving, Scorching, Scraping), Functions, and Foreign Influences.
- **Body Decoration:** Tattoo (*Uli*) vs. Scarification (Tribal Marks), and their cultural values.
- **Mural Art:** Traditional Murals (*Uli*, Hausa, Yoruba), Materials (Traditional vs. Modern), and the "ephemeral" nature.
- **Indigenous Crafts:**
 - *Basketry:* Techniques (Coiling, Plaiting), Materials (Raffia, Cane).
 - *Weaving:* Principles (Warp, Weft, Loom, Shuttle), and key weaving centres (Aso-Ofi, Akwete).
- **Modern Art History:**
 - *The Pioneers:* Aina Onabolu, Akinola Lasekan.
 - *The Masters:* Ben Enwonwu, Uche Okeke, Yusuf Grillo (Zaria Rebels).
 - *The Bridge:* Ladi Kwali (Traditional craft to Studio art).
 - *Contemporary:* Kolade Oshinowo.